

الشاعر

The Poet

A Comprehensive Reference for Arabic Poetry AI Systems

*Forms, Meters, Purposes, and Generation Rules
Across Classical, Dialectal, Performance, and Modern Traditions*

مرجع شامل لأنظمة الذكاء الاصطناعي الشعري العربي
الأشكال والبحور والأغراض وقواعد التوليد
عبر التقاليد الكلاسيكية والعامية والأدائية والحديثة

Internal Development Reference

Contents

1	The Arabic Poetry Landscape	1
1.1	Fourteen Centuries of an Oral Art	1
1.2	Three Major Traditions	1
1.3	A Note on Prosodic Systems	2
1.4	Geographic and Regional Variation	3
1.5	What This Document Covers	5
2	Classical Arabic Poetry	8
2.1	Foundations of Arabic Prosody (علم العروض)	8
2.1.1	The Three Prosodic Building Blocks	8
2.1.2	The Eight Tafeelat	9
2.1.3	The Five Prosodic Circles	11
2.2	The Sixteen Khalilian Meters	11
2.2.1	البحر الطويل — Bahr al-Taweel (“The Long”)	12
2.2.2	البحر البسيط — Bahr al-Baseet (“The Simple”)	12
2.2.3	البحر الكامل — Bahr al-Kamel (“The Complete”)	13
2.2.4	البحر الوافر — Bahr al-Wafir (“The Abundant”)	14
2.2.5	البحر الرجز — Bahr al-Rajaz (“The Trembling”)	14
2.2.6	البحر الرمل — Bahr al-Ramal (“The Sand”)	15
2.2.7	البحر الهزج — Bahr al-Hazaj (“The Buzzing”)	15
2.2.8	البحر الخفيف — Bahr al-Khafeef (“The Light”)	16
2.2.9	البحر السريع — Bahr al-Saree’ (“The Fast”)	16
2.2.10	البحر المتقارب — Bahr al-Mutakareb (“The Approaching”)	17
2.2.11	البحر المتدارك / المحدث — Bahr al-Mutadarak	17
2.3	The Rhyme System (نظام القافية)	18
2.3.1	The Five Rhyme Letters	18
2.3.2	Rhyme Vowel Types (حركات القافية)	18
2.3.3	Qafiya Defects (عيوب القافية)	19
2.3.4	Qafiya Type by Inter-Consonant Vowel Count	19
2.4	Classical Qasida Structure (بنية القصيدة)	20

2.5	Poetic Purposes (أغراض الشعر)	20
2.5.1	المديح — Panegyric	20
2.5.2	الهجاء — Satire/Invective	21
2.5.3	الغزل — Love Poetry	22
2.5.4	الرثاء — Elegy	22
2.5.5	الفخر — Boasting/Self-Glorification	23
2.5.6	الحكمة — Wisdom Poetry	23
2.5.7	الزهد — Asceticism	23
2.5.8	الخمريات — Wine Poetry	23
2.5.9	الشعر الصوفي — Sufi/Mystical Poetry	23
2.6	Intertextual Compositional Forms (الأشكال التناسية)	24
2.6.1	المعارضة — Response/Counter-Poem	24
2.6.2	المساجلة — Poetic Competition	25
2.6.3	التضمين — Intertextual Borrowing	25
2.6.4	التشطير — Hemistichal Splitting	25
2.6.5	التخميس — Quintuple Form	26
2.6.6	إكمال القصيدة — Completing an Unfinished Poem	26
2.6.7	التصوير الشعري — Poetic Visualization	27
2.6.8	شعر المناسبات — Occasional Poetry	27
3	Dialectal and Nabati Poetry	32
3.1	Origins and Historical Development	32
3.1.1	Relationship to Khalilian Prosody	32
3.2	The Nabati Prosodic System	33
3.2.1	Primary Nabati Meters (البحور الرئيسية)	33
3.2.2	Innovated Nabati Meters (البحور المبتكرة)	34
3.3	The Dual-Rhyme System (نظام القافية المزدوجة)	34
3.4	The Hilali and Mashhub Meters in Detail	35
3.4.1	Al-Hilali (الهلالي)	35
3.4.2	Al-Mashhub (المسحوب)	36
3.5	Nabati Poetic Purposes (أغراض الشعر النبطي)	36
3.6	Regional Varieties of Dialectal Poetry	37
3.6.1	Najdi Poetry (الشعر النجدي)	37
3.6.2	Hijazi Poetry (الشعر الحجازي)	38
3.6.3	Gulf Poetry (الشعر الخليجي)	38
3.7	Famous Nabati Poets	39
3.8	AI Implementation Notes for Nabati Poetry	40
4	Performance Poetry Forms	43

4.1	شعر المحاورة والقلطة — Improvised Poetic Dueling	43
4.1.1	Definition and Regional Names	43
4.1.2	The Core Mechanics	44
4.1.3	The Tariq System (نظام الطريق)	44
4.1.4	The Opening and Response Structure	44
4.1.5	Evaluation Criteria	44
4.1.6	Types of محاورة	45
4.2	العرضة الجنوبية — The Southern Ardah	45
4.2.1	Definition and Origins	45
4.2.2	The Performance Structure	46
4.2.3	Poetic Characteristics of the Ardah	46
4.2.4	Historical Forms of the Ardah	46
4.3	السامري — The Samri Tradition	47
4.3.1	Definition and Origins	47
4.3.2	The Performance Structure	47
4.3.3	Poetic Content	48
4.3.4	Instruments	48
4.3.5	Regional Samri Styles	48
4.4	الزجل — The Zajal	49
4.4.1	Definition and Origins	49
4.4.2	Structural Characteristics	49
4.4.3	Lebanese Zajal Forms	50
4.4.4	The Zajal Dueling Format	50
4.4.5	Metrical System	50
4.5	Other Performance Forms	51
4.5.1	الحداء — The Camel-Driver's Call	51
4.5.2	الموال / المواليا — The Mawwal	51
5	Modern Arabic Poetry Forms	54
5.1	شعر التفعيلة — Metrical Free Verse	54
5.1.1	Historical Origins	54
5.1.2	Structural Rules	55
5.1.3	Meter Selection in شعر التفعيلة	55
5.1.4	Al-Sayyab's "Rain Song" — A Reference Example	56
5.1.5	Evaluation Criteria for شعر التفعيلة	56
5.2	قصيدة النثر — The Prose Poem	56
5.2.1	Historical Origins and Theoretical Grounding	57
5.2.2	Defining Characteristics	57
5.2.3	Evaluation Criteria for قصيدة نثر	57

5.3	Mixing Traditions (التمزيج بين التقاليد)	58
A	Complete Meter Reference	62
A.1	All Sixteen Khalilian Meters — Quick Reference	62
A.2	Zehaf Reference	63
A.3	Nabati Meters Quick Reference	64
B	Glossary of Arabic Poetry Terms	65

List of Tables

1.1	Major regional Arabic poetry traditions	4
2.1	Fundamental prosodic units (مكونات العروض)	8
2.2	The eight canonical feet (التفعيلات الثمانية)	10
2.3	The five Khalilian prosodic circles	11
2.4	Al-Taweel structure	12
2.5	Al-Baseet structure	12
2.6	Al-Kamel structure	13
2.7	Al-Wafir structure	14
2.8	Al-Rajaz structure	14
2.9	Al-Ramal structure	15
2.10	Al-Hazaj structure	15
2.11	Al-Khafeef structure	16
2.12	Al-Saree' structure	16
2.13	Al-Mutakareb structure	17
2.14	Al-Mutadarak structure	17
2.15	The five qafiya letters (حروف القافية)	18
2.16	Classical qafiya defects	19
2.17	Qafiya types by vowel structure	19
2.18	Sufi symbolic lexicon	24
2.19	Primary Arabic rhetorical devices (الأساليب البلاغية)	27
3.1	Primary Nabati meters	33
3.2	Innovated Nabati meters	34
3.3	Al-Hilali meter structure	35
3.4	Al-Mashhub meter structure	36
3.5	Nabati poetic purposes	37
3.6	Landmark Nabati poets	39
4.1	Regional names for improvised poetic dueling	43
4.2	Samri instruments	48

4.3	Regional Samri variations	48
5.1	Meter suitability for شعر التفعيلة	55
5.2	Prose poem evaluation dimensions	58
5.3	Modern Arabic poetry tradition overview for AI	59
A.1	Complete Khalilian meter reference	62
A.2	Main zehafs and their effects	63
A.3	Major Nabati meters summary	64

Chapter 1

The Arabic Poetry Landscape

1.1 Fourteen Centuries of an Oral Art

Arabic poetry is among the oldest continuously active literary traditions in the world. From the *Mu'allaqat* — the seven (or ten) pre-Islamic odes said to have been hung on the Ka'ba — through the vast Abbasid court poetry of the eighth through thirteenth centuries, through the Andalusian innovations of *zajal* and *muwashshah*, through the Nabati oral poetry of the Arabian Peninsula, and into the modernist free-verse revolution of the mid-twentieth century, Arabic poetry has never ceased to be composed, recited, memorised, and performed. It has also never settled into a single form.

This document is the primary reference for **The Poet** (الشاعر), an AI system designed to understand, evaluate, and generate Arabic poetry across all major traditions. Understanding those traditions — their distinct rules, their shared roots, their tensions with one another — is prerequisite to building a system that can navigate them competently.

1.2 Three Major Traditions

Arabic poetry as it exists today divides cleanly into three major traditions, each with its own prosodic system, its own repertoire of purposes, and its own performance conventions:

Classical Arabic Poetry (الشعر العربي الفصيح)

Composed in Standard/Classical Arabic (Fusha), governed by the Khalilian prosodic system of sixteen meters (البحور الخليلية الستة عشر), and organised around a set of recognised thematic purposes (أغراض). This is the

tradition that dominates the literary canon, the school curriculum, and academic study of Arabic poetry. It includes pre-Islamic poetry (الشعر الجاهلي), the great Abbasid masters (al-Mutanabbi, Abu Tammam, al-Buhturi), and continues in neo-classical (إحيائي) form to the present.

Dialectal / Nabati Poetry (الشعر العامي / الشعر النبطي)

Composed in the spoken Arabic dialects of the Arabian Peninsula — principally Najdi, Hijazi, Gulf, and Yemeni Arabic — and governed by the Nabati prosodic system, which is parallel to but distinct from the Khalilian system. The Nabati tradition has its own set of meters (بحور نبطية), a distinctive dual-rhyme convention not found in classical poetry, and a performance culture closely tied to tribal identity and oral transmission. It is the dominant poetic tradition in Saudi Arabia and the Gulf states and commands an enormous popular audience.

Modern Forms (الأشكال الشعرية الحديثة)

Emerging in the mid-twentieth century, modern Arabic poetry includes *shi'r al-tafila* (شعر التفعيلة — metrical free verse, retaining classical meters but abandoning fixed line length) and *qasidat al-nathr* (قصيدة النثر — prose poetry, abandoning both meter and rhyme). These forms radically expanded what Arabic poetry could do and who could write it, at the cost of severing the link between poetry and the oral-musical tradition that had sustained it for fourteen centuries.

Beyond these three, several specialised **performance poetry forms** (أشكال الشعر الأدائي) constitute a fourth category: improvised poetic dueling (المحاورة / القلطة), tribal martial performance (العرضة الجنوبية), the Najdi evening tradition (السامري), and the Levantine zajal (الزجل). These forms belong primarily to the dialectal world but have their own specific performance rules, social contexts, and compositional constraints that set them apart from ordinary Nabati verse.

1.3 A Note on Prosodic Systems

A central challenge in Arabic poetry AI is that **each tradition has its own prosodic system**, and those systems, while related, are not interchangeable.

- Classical Arabic prosody (علم العروض) was codified by al-Khalil ibn Ahmad al-Farahidi (718–786 CE) and describes sixteen meters through a binary system of “moving” (متحرك) and “silent” (ساكن) syllables organised into feet (تفعيلات).
- Nabati prosody grew from the same phonological soil as Khalilian prosody but was independently systematised. Because it is realised through the phonol-

ogy of colloquial spoken Arabic, many of its meters are acoustically related to Khalilian meters but scan differently at the phoneme level. A poem that sounds correct in Nabati cannot always be validated using the Khalilian rules.

- Modern free verse (شعر التفعيلة) retains Khalilian feet but applies them without the fixed line structure of the classical bayt. Validation requires identifying the chosen foot and checking that each line is built from valid iterations of that foot.
- Prose poetry (قصيدة النثر) has no prosodic constraints in the traditional sense. Evaluation is entirely qualitative: density of imagery, internal rhythm, linguistic concentration.

This means that **The Poet** must know *which tradition a given request belongs to* before it can apply the correct generation and evaluation logic. The constraint-parsing layer is therefore one of the most critical components of the system.

1.4 Geographic and Regional Variation

Arabic poetry is not geographically homogeneous. Significant regional traditions exist:

Table 1.1: Major regional Arabic poetry traditions

Region	Arabic	Primary Dialect	Dominant Form(s)
Najd / Central Arabia	نجد	Najdi Arabic	Nabati, Samri
Hijaz (Mecca-Medina)	المجاز	Hijazi Arabic	Muhawara / Qalta
Gulf (Kuwait, UAE, Qatar, Bahrain)	الخليج	Gulf Arabic	Nabati, Samri, Muhawara
Southern Saudi (Asir, Jizan)	جنوب المملكة	Asiri/Jizan Arabic	Al-Ardah al-Janubiyya
Levant (Lebanon, Syria, Palestine)	بلاد الشام	Levantine Arabic	Zajal (Lebanese form)
Egypt	مصر	Egyptian Arabic	Zajal (Egyptian form), mawwal
Yemen	اليمن	Yemeni Arabic	Humaini poetry, Nabati variants
Maghreb (Morocco, Algeria, Tunisia)	المغرب العربي	Darija	Zajal (Maghrebi form), mal-hun

For the initial implementation of **The Poet**, the primary focus is on the traditions most commonly requested by Arabic-speaking users in the Gulf and Levant: classical Fusha poetry, Arabian Peninsula Nabati poetry, and Gulf performance forms. Egyptian and Levantine dialectal forms are supported at a secondary level.

1.5 What This Document Covers

The following chapters form the complete poetry reference for **The Poet**:

Chapter 2: Classical Arabic Poetry

The Khalilian prosodic system in full; the sixteen meters with tafeelat patterns, zehafs, and aruz/dharb combinations; the full system of poetic purposes (أغراض); classical qasida structure; and all intertextual compositional forms (معارضة، مساجلة، تضمين، تشطير، تخميس، إكمال، تصوير).

Chapter 3: Dialectal / Nabati Poetry

The Nabati prosodic system; its twelve major meters; the dual-rhyme convention; regional dialects and style markers; and the major أغراض of the Nabati tradition.

Chapter 4: Performance Poetry Forms

The rules and structure of improvised poetic dueling (المحاورة / القلطة); the Southern Ardah (العرضة الجنوبية); the Samri tradition (السامري); and the Levantine Zajal (الزجل).

Chapter 5: Modern Arabic Poetry

شعر التفعيلة theory and compositional rules; قصيدة النثر characteristics and evaluation criteria; the relationship between modern and traditional forms.

النسخة العربية

أربعة عشر قرناً من فن شفهي

الشعر العربي من أقدم التقاليد الأدبية الحية المستمرة في العالم. من المعلقات السبع التي قيل إنها علقت على الكعبة المشرفة في الجاهلية، مروراً بشعر البلاط الأموي والعباسي الضخم، ثم الابتكارات الأندلسية في الزجل والموشحات، ثم الشعر النبطي الشفهي في الجزيرة العربية، وصولاً إلى ثورة شعر التفعيلة في منتصف القرن العشرين – لم يتوقف الشعر العربي عن التأليف والإلقاء والحفظ والأداء، ولم يستقر قط في شكل واحد.

هذه الوثيقة هي المرجع الرئيسي لنظام الشاعر، وهو نظام ذكاء اصطناعي مصمم لفهم الشعر العربي وتقييمه وتوليدته عبر جميع تقاليده الكبرى.

ثلاثة تقاليد كبرى

ينقسم الشعر العربي كما هو اليوم إلى ثلاثة تقاليد كبرى، لكلٍ منها نظامه العروضي الخاص، وخزائنه من الأغراض، وأعرافه الأدائية:

الشعر العربي الفصيح يُنظم باللغة العربية الفصيحة، ويخضع للنظام العروضي الخليلي القائم على ستة عشر بحراً، ويتنظم حول أغراض شعرية معروفة. وهو التقليد الذي يهيمن على الكنز الأدبي والمناهج المدرسية والدراسات الأكاديمية، ويشمل الشعر الجاهلي، وعمالة العصر العباسي كالمثنوي وأبي تمام والبحري، ويستمر حتى اليوم في صورته الإحيائية.

الشعر العامي / الشعر النبطي يُنظم باللهجات العربية المحكية في شبه الجزيرة العربية – النجدية والحجازية والخليجية واليمينية – ويخضع للنظام العروضي النبطي، وهو نظام مستقل عن الخليلي وإن كان متوازياً معه. للتقليد النبطي بحوره الخاصة، ونظام قافية مزدوجة لا نظير له في الشعر الكلاسيكي، وثقافة أداء مرتبطة ارتباطاً وثيقاً بالهوية القبلية والرواية الشفهية.

الأشكال الشعرية الحديثة تشمل شعر التفعيلة (الذي يحافظ على البحور الخليلية لكنه يتخلى عن الشطرين الثابتين) وقصيدة النثر (التي تتخلى عن الوزن والقافية معاً). هذه الأشكال وسّعت آفاق الشعر العربي توسيعاً جذرياً، غير أنها قطعت الصلة بالتقليد الشفهي الموسيقي الذي أمد الشعر بحياته أربعة عشر قرناً.

ملاحظة حول الأنظمة العروضية

التحدي المحوري في الذكاء الاصطناعي الشعري العربي هو أن لكل تقليد نظامه العروضي الخاص، وهذه الأنظمة – وإن كانت متعلقة ببعضها – غير قابلة للتبادل:

- العروض العربي الكلاسيكي قننه الخليل بن أحمد الفراهيدي (718-786م) ويصف ستة عشر بحراً عبر نظام ثنائي من المتحرك والساكن مرتباً في تفعيلات.
 - العروض النبطي نما من نفس البيئة الصوتية الخليلية لكنه وُضع بصورة مستقلة، وكثير من بحوره مرتبطة صوتياً بالبحور الخليلية لكنها تختلف عنها على مستوى المقاطع.
 - شعر التفعيلة يحتفظ بالتفعيلات الخليلية لكن بدون التقييد بطول البيت الثابت.
 - قصيدة النثر لا قيود عروضية عليها، والتقييم فيها نوعي بحت.
- هذا يعني أن نظام الشاعر يجب أن يحدد التقليد الذي ينتمي إليه الطلب قبل تطبيق منطق التوليد والتقييم المناسب.

Chapter 2

Classical Arabic Poetry

Classical Arabic poetry (الشعر العربي الفصيح) is governed by one of the most rigorously codified prosodic systems in literary history. This chapter documents that system in full, as required for AI generation and evaluation.

2.1 Foundations of Arabic Prosody (علم العروض)

Arabic prosody was codified by **al-Khalil ibn Ahmad al-Farahidi** (718–786 CE) in his treatise *Kitab al-'Arud*. His system describes all valid Arabic poetic meters through combinations of three fundamental prosodic units:

2.1.1 The Three Prosodic Building Blocks

Table 2.1: Fundamental prosodic units (مكونات العروض)

Unit	Arabic	Definition	Pattern	Example
Sabab Khafif	سبب خفيف	Moving + quiescent	1 0	مَنْ
Sabab Thaqil	سبب ثقیل	Moving + moving	1 1	مَعَ (rare)
Watad Majmu'	وتد مجموع	Moving + moving + quiescent	1 1 0	فَعَوْ
Watad Mafruq	وتد مفروق	Moving + quiescent + moving	1 0 1	مَفْعُ
Fasila Sughra	فاصلة صغرى	Three moving + quiescent	1 1 1 0	فَعْلَنْ
Fasila Kubra	فاصلة كبرى	Four moving + quiescent	1 1 1 1 0	فَعْلَتَنْ

Binary notation convention: Throughout this document, **1** denotes a moving (متحرك) position (a consonant bearing any short vowel), and **0** denotes a quiescent (ساكن) position (a consonant bearing sukun, or a long vowel ا/و/ي). Long vowels are inherently quiescent in the scan.

2.1.2 The Eight Tafeelat

Al-Khalil derived eight canonical feet (تفعيلات) from these building blocks. All sixteen meters are constructed from these eight feet:

Table 2.2: The eight canonical feet (التفعيلات الثمانية)

Name (Arabic)	Name (Transcription)	Pattern	Com-Used In po- nents
فَعُولُنْ	Fa'ulun	1 1 0 1 0	WatadTaweel, Mutakareb ma- jmu' + sabab khafif
مَفَاعِيلُنْ	Mafa'ilun	1 1 0 1 1 0	WatadTaweel, Hazaj ma- jmu' + sabab thaqil + sabab khafif
مَفَاعِلَتُنْ	Mafa'alatun	1 1 0 1 1 1 0	WataWafir ma- jmu' + fasila sughra + ...
فَاعِلُنْ	Fa'ilun	1 0 1 1 0	SababBaseet, Taweel khafif + watad ma- jmu'
فَاعِلَاتُنْ	Fa'ilatun	1 0 1 1 0 1 0	SababRamal, Khafeef khafif + watad ma- jmu' + sabab khafif
مُسْتَفْعِلُنْ	Mustaf'ilun	1 0 1 0 1 1 0	SababBaseet, Rajaz, Saree khafif + sabab khafif +

2.1.3 The Five Prosodic Circles

Al-Khalil organised the meters into five abstract **prosodic circles** (الدوائر العروضية الخمس). Meters in the same circle share the same cyclic root and differ only in the starting point of the reading:

Table 2.3: The five Khalilian prosodic circles

Circle	Arabic Name	Meters	Dominant Foot Type
1	دائرة المختلف	Taweel, Madeed, Baseet	Mixed (watad + sababaan)
2	دائرة المؤتلف	Wafir, Kamel	Fasila-based
3	دائرة المجتلب	Hazaj, Rajaz, Ramal	Repeated sabab-watad
4	دائرة المشتبه	Saree, Munsareh, Khafeef, Mudhare, Muqtadheb, Mujtath	Contains watad mafruq
5	دائرة المتفق	Mutakareb, Mutadarak	Pure trisyllabic feet

2.2 The Sixteen Khalilian Meters

Each meter entry below provides: (1) the canonical tafeelat for both hemistichs; (2) the binary pattern; (3) the main zehafs and their effect; (4) the valid aruz/dharb combinations; (5) typical themes; and (6) a famous example verse with full diacritics.

2.2.1 البحر الطويل — Bahr al-Taweel (“The Long”)

Table 2.4: Al-Taweel structure

Hemistich (Sadr/Ajuz)	فَعُولُنْ مَفَاعِيلُنْ فَعُولُنْ مَفَاعِيلُنْ
Pattern	11010 110110 11010 110110
Circle	(1) دائرة المختلف
Aruz (عروض)	فَعُولُ → مقبوضة (Qabadh: 5th element quiescent)
Dharb (ضرب)	مَفَاعِيلُنْ: صحيح فَعْلٌ: محذوف فَعُولٌ: مقبوض
Main Zehafs	فَعُولُ → فَعُولُنْ: removes 5th element of القَبْض فَاعِيلُنْ → فَعُولُنْ: removes 1st element → فَاعِيلُنْ (rare) الثَم
Frequency	Most common meter in classical Arabic poetry (>40% of Diwan)
Typical Themes	All purposes — this is the “default” meter for serious poetry

قَفَا نَبْكَ مِنْ ذِكْرِي حَبِيبٍ وَمَنْزِلِ بِسِقْطِ اللَّوَى بَيْنَ الدَّخُولِ فَخَوَّمِلِ

Imru' al-Qays, Mu'allaqah (opening verse)

2.2.2 البحر البسيط — Bahr al-Baseet (“The Simple”)

Table 2.5: Al-Baseet structure

Hemistich	مُسْتَفْعِلُنْ فَاعِلُنْ مُسْتَفْعِلُنْ فَاعِلُنْ
Pattern	1010110 10110 1010110 10110
Circle	(1) دائرة المختلف
Aruz	مُسْتَفْعِلُنْ (Khaban on مُفَاعِلُنْ: مخبونة)
Dharb	فَعْلُنْ: مقطوع فَعِلُنْ: مخبون
Main Zehafs	مُفَاعِلُنْ → مُسْتَفْعِلُنْ: removes 2nd element الخَبْن مُسْتَعِلُنْ → مُسْتَفْعِلُنْ: removes 4th element الطِي
Frequency	Second most common meter
Typical Themes	Lament (رثاء), description (وصف), wisdom (حكمة)

أَنَا الَّذِي نَظَرَ الْأَعْمَى إِلَى أَدْبِي وَأَسَمِعَتْ كَلِمَاتِي مَنْ بِهِ صَمٌّ

Al-Mutanabbi

2.2.3 البحر الكامل — Bahr al-Kamel (“The Complete”)

Table 2.6: Al-Kamel structure

Hemistich	مُتَفَاعِلُنْ مُتَفَاعِلُنْ مُتَفَاعِلُنْ
Pattern	1110110 1110110 1110110
Circle	(2) دائرة المؤتلف
Aruz	مُتَفَاعِلُنْ: مُضَمَّرَةٌ مُتَفَاعِلُنْ: صَحِيحَةٌ
Dharb	فَعْلَاتُنْ: أَحْثْ, مُتَفَاعِلُنْ: مَقْطُوعٌ, مُضَمَّرٌ, صَحِيحٌ
Main Zehafs	(مُتَفَاعِلُنْ → مُتَفَاعِلُنْ) vowels 2nd element: الإضممار الوقص: removes 2nd element (rare, only in hashw) الحث: combines إضممار + وقص on fasila
Frequency	Third most common; the meter of al-Mutanabbi’s great odes
Typical Themes	Panegyric (مدح), martial (حماسة), boasting (نخر)

وَعَلَى الرِّيَّاحِ يَرُودُ نَبِيٌّ أَنِّي قَوْمْتُ مِنْ عَوَجِ الرَّدَى سَهْمًا مُقِيمًا

Al-Mutanabbi, from his Kafur odes

2.2.4 البحر الوافر — Bahr al-Wafir (“The Abundant”)

Table 2.7: Al-Wafir structure

Hemistich	مُفَاعِلَتُنْ مُفَاعِلَتُنْ مُفَاعِلَتُنْ (full)
Pattern	1101110 1101110 (aruz variant)
Circle	دائرة المؤتلف (2)
Aruz/Dharb	Always مَقْطُوفَة (عصب): 5th + 6th elements quiescent → مُفَاعِلَتُنْ → مُفَاعِلَتُنْ
Main Zehafs	العصب: suppresses 5th element in مُفَاعِلَتُنْ → مُفَاعِلَتُنْ (mandatory in aruz/dharb)
Note	The عصب modification makes the full form of مُفَاعِلَتُنْ extremely rare in the last foot
Frequency	Common; associated with emotional and lyric poetry
Typical Themes	Love (غزل), longing (شوق), elegy (رثاء)

2.2.5 البحر الرجز — Bahr al-Rajaz (“The Trembling”)

Table 2.8: Al-Rajaz structure

Hemistich	مُسْتَفْعِلُنْ مُسْتَفْعِلُنْ مُسْتَفْعِلُنْ
Pattern	1010110 (× 3 per hemistich)
Circle	دائرة المجتلب (3)
Special Forms	مجزوء: 2 feet per hemistich مشطور: 3 feet total (single shatr) منهوك: 2 feet total
Unique Feature	The only meter in which a poet may compose alone (using مشطور/منهوك forms) without a response partner; this makes it the meter of الأراجيز (didactic solo verse)
Main Zehafs	الخبن + طي (= الخبل, الطي, الحبن simultaneously)
Frequency	Very common; the original meter of حذاء (camel-driver’s song)
Typical Themes	Didactic poetry (الأراجيز التعليمية), warrior/martial, improvised verse

2.2.6 البحر الرمل — Bahr al-Ramal (“The Sand”)

Table 2.9: Al-Ramal structure

Hemistich	فَاعِلَاتُنْ فَاعِلَاتُنْ فَاعِلَاتُنْ
Pattern	1011010 (× 3 per hemistich)
Circle	(3) دائرة المجتلب
Aruz	Always truncated (محذوف): فَاعِلَاتُنْ → فَاعِلَا (= فَاعِلَاتُ with last element dropped)
Dharb	فَاعِلَاتُنْ مخبون فَاعِلَا محذوف and variants
Main Zehafs	الخبين: removes 2nd element الكف: removes 7th element
Frequency	Common, especially in Andalusian and post-classical poetry
Typical Themes	Lyric poetry (غزل), description (وصف), Sufi poetry

2.2.7 البحر الهزج — Bahr al-Hazaj (“The Buzzing”)

Table 2.10: Al-Hazaj structure

Hemistich	مَفَاعِيلُنْ مَفَاعِيلُنْ
Pattern	110110 110110
Circle	(3) دائرة المجتلب
Aruz	Intact (سالمة) or with kaf (مكفوفة): مَفَاعِيلُ
Dharb	مَفَاعِيلُ محذوف مَفَاعِيلُنْ سالم
Main Zehafs	القبض (مَفَاعِيلُنْ) الكف: removes 7th element (position 6 of مَفَاعِيلُنْ) disallowed in hashw
Note	The simplest meter — only two feet per hemistich; often used for songs
Typical Themes	Light songs (أغاني), love (غزل), folk verse

2.2.8 البحر الخفيف — Bahr al-Khafeef (“The Light”)

Table 2.11: Al-Khafeef structure

Hemistich	فَاعِلَاتُنْ مُسْتَفْعِ لُنْ فَاعِلَاتُنْ
Pattern	1011010 101010 1011010
Circle	دائرة المشتبه (4) — contains watad mafruq
Aruz	Intact (سالمة) or khabun: فَعَلَاتُنْ
Dharb	فَاعِلَاً: محذوف فَاعِلَاتٌ: مشعوث سالم
Main Zehafs	الخبن on فَاعِلَاتُنْ (positions 1,2)
Note	The watad mafruq (101) in مُسْتَفْعِ لُنْ is a fixed constraint — its 2nd element (position 2 of the foot = position 2 of the bayt-middle foot) must remain quiescent
Typical Themes	Social/occasional verse, wisdom, religious poetry

2.2.9 البحر السريع — Bahr al-Saree’ (“The Fast”)

Table 2.12: Al-Saree’ structure

Hemistich	مُسْتَفْعِلُنْ مُسْتَفْعِلُنْ مَفْعُولَاتٌ
Pattern	1010110 1010110 1010110
Circle	دائرة المشتبه (4)
Note on mafoolat	مَفْعُولَاتٌ contains a watad mafruq; this foot only appears at the end
Aruz/Dharb	مَفْعُولَاتٌ takes وقف (position 6 quiescent) → مَكْشُوفَةٌ/مَوْقُوفَةٌ or كَسَف (removes last element) → مَفْعُولَاً
Main Zehafs	الخبن + طي (= الخبل) الخبن on مُسْتَفْعِلُنْ (removes 4th element)
Typical Themes	Heroic, panegyric

2.2.10 البحر المتقارب — Bahr al-Mutakareb (“The Approaching”)

Table 2.13: Al-Mutakareb structure

Hemistich	فَعُولُنْ فَعُولُنْ فَعُولُنْ فَعُولُنْ
Pattern	11010 (× 4 per hemistich)
Circle	(5) دائرة المتفق
Aruz	(فَعْلٌ =) فَعْلٌ: محذوفة فَعُولٌ: مقبوضة
Dharb	فَعْلُنْ: أبتَر, محذوف, مقبوض
Main Zehafs	القَبْضُ: removes 5th element → فَعُولٌ الثَلْمُ: removes 1st element (rare) الثَرَمُ: removes 1st + 2nd (very rare)
Frequency	Common in epic-narrative poetry; the meter of Ferdowsi’s <i>Shah-nameh</i> equivalent in Arabic
Typical Themes	Epics, heroic narrative, occasional

أَلَا لَيْتَ الشَّبَابَ يَعُودُ يَوْمًا فَأُخْبِرُهُ بِمَا فَعَلَ الْمَشِيبُ

Classical verse attributed to multiple poets

2.2.11 البحر المتدارك / المحدث — Bahr al-Mutadarak

Table 2.14: Al-Mutadarak structure

Hemistich	فَاعِلُنْ فَاعِلُنْ فَاعِلُنْ فَاعِلُنْ
Pattern	10110 (× 4 per hemistich)
Circle	(5) دائرة المتفق
Historical Note	Added by al-Akhfash al-Awsat after al-Khalil’s death, hence called المحدث (the newly added); al-Khalil recognised it but didn’t include it
Zehafs	الْخَبْنُ: removes 2nd element → فَعِلُنْ
Typical Themes	Songs, light poetry, modern verse

The remaining six meters — المجتث, المقتضب, المضارع, المنسرح, المديد — are summarised in Appendix A with full structural data. They are rare in the corpus and primarily appear in specific thematic contexts (mujtath: occasional verse; mudhare: very rare; maqtadheb: nearly extinct in practice).

2.3 The Rhyme System (نظام القافية)

2.3.1 The Five Rhyme Letters

Arabic rhyme is not simply end-rhyme. A classical qafiya is defined by up to five letters that form a structural unit at the end of each verse:

Table 2.15: The five qafiya letters (حروف القافية)

Letter	Arabic	Position	Definition
Al-Rawiy	الرَّوِّي	Mandatory	The main rhyme consonant; defines the rhyme entirely
Al-Wasl	الوَصل	Optional	Follows the rawiy; can be هاء, long vowel, or n. of tanwin
Al-Khuruuj	الخُرُوج	Optional	Vowel on the wasl consonant
Al-Radf	الرَّدْف	Optional	Precedes rawiy; must be a long vowel (ا، و، ي) or hamza
Al-Ta'siis	التَّأْسِيس	Optional	ألف two positions before rawiy, always with a consonant between

2.3.2 Rhyme Vowel Types (حركات القافية)

المطلقة The rawiy bears a short vowel; the verse ends with an open syllable. Most common and musically richest.

المُقَيَّدَة The rawiy bears a sukun; the verse ends with a closed syllable. More austere.

المَجْرَدَة The rawiy is bare (no radf, no ta'siis).

المُرَدَّفَة The rawiy is preceded by a radf (long vowel before the rhyme consonant).

المُؤَسَّسَة The rawiy is preceded by a ta'siis (alif two positions back).

2.3.3 Qafiya Defects (عيوب القافية)

Table 2.16: Classical qafiya defects

Name	Arabic	Definition
Al-'Ita'	الإيطاء	Repeating the exact same word as rawiy in two or more verses (the worst defect)
Al-Ikfa'	الإكفاء	Using two different letters that are similar in articulation as rawiy (ن/م etc.)
Al-Sinnad	السناد	Inconsistency in the radf or ta'siis between verses
Al-Iqwa'	الإقواء	Mixing kasra and damma on the rawiy in the same poem
Al-'Israf	الإصراف	Mixing fatha with kasra or damma on the rawiy
Al-Ijazah	الإجازة	Changing the rawiy letter mid-poem

2.3.4 Qafiya Type by Inter-Consonant Vowel Count

Table 2.17: Qafiya types by vowel structure

Type	Arabic	Vowels Between	Description	Example Ending
Mutawatir	مُتَوَاتِرٌ	One	One vowel between last two consonants	وَطْنٌ، شَجْنٌ
Mutadaarik	مُتَدَارِكٌ	Two	Two vowels between last two consonants	كِتَابَةٌ، سَمَاءُ
Mutarakib	مُتَرَكَبٌ	Three	Three vowels between last two consonants	حَبِيبَانِ، عَزِيزَانِ
Mutakaasis	مُتَكَاسِسٌ	Four	Four vowels between last two consonants	complex words
Mutaradif	مُتَرَادِفٌ	Zero (two sukuns)	Two consecutive sukuns at end	دِينَ، عَيْنَ

2.4 Classical Qasida Structure (بنية القصيدة)

The classical Arabic qasida (القصيد الكلاسيكية) follows a conventional tripartite or quadripartite structure, though not every poem adheres to it:

1. **المطلع / النسيب** — *The amatory prelude / opening*. The poem traditionally opens with a lament at a deserted campsite (الوقوف على الأطلال) or an evocation of the beloved's memory. This establishes an emotional key. The quality of the مطلع (opening verse) was considered the most critical measure of a poem's success — it must arrest the listener immediately.
2. **الرحيل / التخلص** — *The journey / transition*. The poet shifts from the opening mood toward the poem's main purpose, often through the image of a desert journey or a description of the poet's camel/horse.
3. **الغرض الرئيسي** — *The main purpose section*. Panegyric, elegy, boasting, satire — this is where the declared purpose of the poem is fulfilled.
4. **الخاتمة** — *The conclusion*. Often a prayer, a maxim, or a return to the opening image.

Rules for a مطلع حسن (Excellent Opening Verse)

- The opening verse must be complete in meaning — it must not require the next verse to make sense.
- It should establish the emotional tone of the entire poem.
- It should exhibit براعة الاستهلال (masterly beginning): an image, sound, or idea that captures the listener's full attention immediately.
- It should avoid التعقيد اللفظي (verbal complexity) — the opening must be immediately accessible.
- The first hemistich (الصدر) establishes the rhyme letter (الروي) for the entire poem. The second hemistich (العجز) also rhymes with it — the first مصرع (both hemistichs rhyme).

2.5 Poetic Purposes (أغراض الشعر)

2.5.1 المديح — Panegyric

The most commercially and politically significant غرض in the classical tradition. A panegyric poet praised rulers, tribal chiefs, or patrons in exchange for gifts and protection.

Structural Progression: The classical مديحة typically moves through: (1) an ama-

tory or descriptive opening (نسيب); (2) a transition (تخلص) introducing the praised person; (3) the panegyric body enumerating the **four cardinal virtues**: generosity (الكرم), valor (الشجاعة), wisdom (الحلم), justice (العدل); (4) a supplicatory close.

Language & Style: Grand, elevated diction; extensive use of superlative forms; comparison with natural phenomena (the praised person's generosity = the sea; courage = a lion or eagle); hyperbole (المبالغة) is not a defect but a required feature.

Meters Preferred: al-Taweel, al-Baseet, al-Kamel, al-Wafir.

Key Poets: al-Mutanabbi (Abu al-Tayyib Ahmad ibn al-Husayn), al-Buhturi, Abu Tammam, al-Farazdaq, Hassan ibn Thabit.

لَكَ يَا مَنَازِلُ فِي الْقُلُوبِ مَنَازِلُ أَقْفَرْتَ أَنْتِ وَهْنٌ مِنْكَ أَوَاهِلُ

Al-Mutanabbi (Kamel meter)

AI Generation Rules:

- The system must know *who* is being praised and *for what qualities* before generating.
- The standard three-phase structure (nasib → takhallus → madih body) must be maintained unless the user specifies otherwise.
- Hyperbole is correct in this *غرض*; the evaluator must not penalise it.

2.5.2 الهجاء — Satire/Invective

The inverse of madih: systematic attack on an enemy's character, lineage, appearance, and moral failings. Among the most feared forms of speech in early Arab culture — powerful enough that certain pre-Islamic practices surrounded its delivery with protective ritual.

Sub-type — النقائض (Poetic Flyting): Two poets attack each other using the *same meter and rhyme*, each poem a direct response to the other's. The great نقائض exchanges of Jarir, al-Farazdaq, and al-Akhtal (c.700 CE) are the canonical examples. Rules: the responding poem *must* use the same meter and rhyme as the poem being answered; the responding poet *must* address every accusation before adding new ones.

AI Generation Rules:

- For هجاء as a new composition: the target's failings (stinginess = البخل, cowardice = الجبن, low birth = لؤم الأصل) must be specified.
- For نقائض: the system must read the original attack poem in full before generating the response; meter and rhyme are non-negotiable.

2.5.3 الغزل — Love Poetry

Divided into two fundamentally different schools:

الغزل العذري *Udhri/Platonic love*: Chaste, idealised, often unrequited love. Named after the Banu Udhrah tribe of the Hijaz. Characterised by: absolute prohibition on describing the beloved's body; the lover as a willing martyr to love; the beloved as unattainable ideal. Canonical figures: Qays and Layla (مجنون ليلى), Jamil and Buthayna (جميل بثينة), Kuthayyir and Azza.

الغزل الحسي / الصريح *Sensual/explicit love*: Bold physical description; celebration of desire and consummation. The Hijazi/Umayyad school centred on **Umar ibn Abi Rabi'a** (d. 712 CE). Meters: Ramal, Sari', Hazaj preferred.

AI Generation Rules:

- The system must distinguish between عذري and حسي modes — they have different constraints on body imagery.
- In عذري: body description is prohibited; emotional and psychological states are the content.
- In حسي: physical description is not only permitted but expected.
- The meter itself often signals the mode: Taweel/Baseet → more likely عذري; Ramal/Hazaj → more likely حسي.

2.5.4 الرثاء — Elegy

Mourning poetry for the dead. Structurally, رثاء is praise of the deceased combined with grief at the loss — it shares vocabulary and technique with مدح but in a minor emotional key.

Key feature: The best رثاء alternates between الحزن (grief) and التمجيد (glorification). Pure lament without glorification is a defect.

Famous poetess: al-Khansa' (الخنساء) — her elegies for her brothers Sakhr and Mu'awiya remain the canonical model.

AI Generation Rules:

- The AI must know who is being mourned (person, relationship, qualities to glorify) and whether the tone should be personal grief or communal mourning.
- Meter: al-Taweel and al-Baseet are traditional; al-Wafir is also common.

2.5.5 الفخر — Boasting/Self-Glorification

Glorification of the self, one's tribe, and one's deeds. The dominant tone is elevated pride, not mere self-promotion. In pre-Islamic and Umayyad poetry, personal **نفر** was inseparable from tribal identity.

2.5.6 الحكمة — Wisdom Poetry

Philosophical and moral aphorisms in verse. Brief, memorable, self-contained verses. Famous: Zuhair ibn Abi Sulma's **معلقة**, Imru' al-Qays's philosophical lines, the gnomic verses of Labid.

AI generation note: **حكمة** verses are typically stand-alone — a two-hemistich **بيت** that delivers a complete insight. The AI should generate complete, pithy, universal statements.

2.5.7 الزهد — Asceticism

Renunciation of worldly pleasures and focus on the afterlife. Associated with: Abu al-Atahiya (d. 828 CE), the most prolific **زهد** poet. Language is plain, direct, and rhythmically simple — deliberately avoiding the grandeur of **مديح**.

2.5.8 الخمریات — Wine Poetry

Celebration of wine and drinking culture. Abu Nuwas (d. c.815 CE) is the supreme master. **Note for AI:** In Sufi poetry (Ibn al-Farid, Omar Khayyam in Arabic translation, etc.), wine lexicon (**ساقی**, **كأس**, **نحمر**) carries a spiritual allegorical meaning (wine = divine knowledge; the cup-bearer = the Sufi master). The AI must distinguish literal from allegorical register.

2.5.9 الشعر الصوفي — Sufi/Mystical Poetry

A major tradition from the 9th century onward. Key figures: al-Hallaj, Rabi'a al-Adawiyya, Ibn Arabi, Ibn al-Farid. Characteristics: deliberate ambiguity between human and divine love; lexical borrowing from **غزل** and **نحمریات**; mystical paradox (**شطح**).

Core Sufi symbolic system (for AI evaluation):

Table 2.18: Sufi symbolic lexicon

Literal Image	Arabic	Sufi Referent
Wine (الخمر)		Divine knowledge / gnosis
Tavern (الحانة)		The Sufi tekke / path
Cup-bearer (الساق)		The Sufi master / God
Drunkenness (السكر)		Ecstatic union (وجد)
The Beloved (الحبيب / المحبوب)		The Divine

2.6 Intertextual Compositional Forms (الأشكال التناسلية)

These forms are compositional operations that relate a new poem to an existing one. They are among the most technically demanding requests the system will receive.

2.6.1 المعارضة — Response/Counter-Poem

A new poem composed using the **same meter and same rhyme letter** as an existing poem, with the implicit or explicit claim of matching or surpassing the original.

Rules for المعارضة

1. **Meter:** Must be identical — the same Khalilian meter; even the sub-type (e.g., if original uses مجزوء البسيط, the response must too).
2. **Rhyme:** Must use the *exact same rawiy letter*. The harakah on the rawiy (the vowel type) must also match.
3. **Theme:** Can differ — the *معارضة* may take a completely different purpose (غرض) from the original, or may engage with the same themes.
4. **Length:** Need not match the original exactly, but a *معارضة* shorter than the original is considered inferior by convention.
5. **Quality criterion:** The *معارضة* succeeds when it is judged to match or exceed the original's quality. This requires the AI to read the full source poem before generating.

Famous examples: Al-Buhturi's *معارضة* of al-Mutanabbi; neo-classical poets Ahmad Shawqi and Hafiz Ibrahim wrote *معارضات* of Imru' al-Qays's Mu'allaqah.

2.6.2 المساجلة — Poetic Competition

Two or more poets exchange verses in turn, each attempting to outdo the other in wit, imagery, and prosodic mastery. A مساجلة is not merely back-and-forth — it follows rules:

Rules for المساجلة

1. Both poets use the same meter and rhyme throughout the exchange.
2. Each poet's entry must respond to the specific *argument* or *image* of the previous poet — not simply continue the same subject.
3. The exchange continues until one poet is unable to respond or the agreed number of turns is complete.
4. A poet who changes the meter or rhyme mid-exchange concedes defeat.

2.6.3 التضمين — Intertextual Borrowing

Incorporating a full verse or hemistich from another poet into one's own poem, where it becomes structurally integrated into the new poem's flow.

تضمين Borrowing from another poet's verse. May be acknowledged (تضمين صريح) or left for the reader to recognise (تضمين خفي).

اقتباس Borrowing from the Quran or Hadith. Treated differently — governed by additional literary and religious norms.

تلميح Mere allusion to a famous text without direct quotation — the weakest form of intertextuality.

AI rule: The borrowed hemistich must fit seamlessly — same meter, same rhyme position if it's at the end of a verse. The surrounding context must make the borrowing feel intentional and meaningful, not forced.

2.6.4 التشطير — Hemistichal Splitting

Taking an existing poem and inserting new hemistichs into each verse, effectively doubling the length of each بيت. The original hemistichs are *immutable*; the poet inserts a new hemistich before each original hemistich.

Structure of a تشطير verse:

[New hemistich A] + [Original hemistich 1 (sadr)] +
[New hemistich B] + [Original hemistich 2 (ajuz)]

Rules for التشطير

1. The original verses are reproduced without any modification.
2. New hemistichs use the same meter as the original.
3. New hemistichs may or may not rhyme with the original's rawiy — if they do, the effect is richer.
4. The semantic flow from new hemistich → original hemistich must be smooth and logical.
5. The inserted hemistichs must not contradict or undermine the meaning of the original.

2.6.5 التخميس — Quintuple Form

Adding three new hemistichs to each original بيت, creating a five-line unit (نُحَاسِيَّة). The structure is: AAA-BC where A = three new lines sharing an internal rhyme, B = original sadr, C = original ajuz.

Rules for التخميس

1. The three new lines (A, A, A) share a rhyme among themselves, different from the original poem's rhyme.
2. The third new line must lead naturally into the original صدر — it is the transition.
3. The original صدر (B) and عجز (C) are reproduced exactly.
4. The new lines use the same meter as the original.

2.6.6 إكمال القصيدة — Completing an Unfinished Poem

Completing a poem that the original poet left unfinished, or that exists only in fragmentary form.

Rules for إكمال القصيدة

1. **Meter and rhyme** must be maintained without exception.
2. **Emotional register and tone** must match the existing verses — if the opening is mournful, the completion cannot shift to celebration.
3. **Sentence length patterns**: if the original uses long, flowing sentences, the completion should not suddenly shift to short staccato hemistichs.
4. **Vocabulary level**: if the original uses archaic/Bedouin diction (لغة بدوية), the completion must maintain this register.
5. **Imagery density**: if the original is rich in simile and metaphor, the completion must match that density.
6. The completion should provide a convincing خاتمة — a sense of closure.

2.6.7 التصوير الشعري — Poetic Visualization

Translating a scene, experience, or concept into verse using the full range of Arabic rhetorical devices (البلاغة).

Table 2.19: Primary Arabic rhetorical devices (الأساليب البلاغية)

Device	Arabic	Definition and AI Generation Note
Simile	التشبيه	Explicit comparison (A is like B); requires مثل , كأن , or equivalent. Most common device.
Metaphor	الاستعارة	Implicit comparison; A is called B without the comparison particle.
Metonymy	الكناية	Describing A by describing its characteristic attribute B (“heavy-handed” for generous).
Synecdoche	المجاز المرسل	Part for whole or whole for part; figurative extension.
Antithesis	الطباق	Pairing contrasting concepts in the same verse. Highly valued in Abbasid poetry.
Paranomasia	الجناس	Wordplay on similar-sounding words with different meanings.

2.6.8 شعر المناسبات — Occasional Poetry

Poetry composed for specific social occasions. Subtypes:

- **التهنئة** (Congratulatory): Weddings, births, promotions, achievements. Tone: joyful, elevated.

- العزاء / التعزية (Condolence): Death, illness, misfortune. Tone: measured grief, comfort.
- المديح الرسمي (Official praise): State occasions, national days. Tone: formal, civic.
- الوصف التصويري (Descriptive occasion): Describing a place, event, season. Tone: varies.

النسخة العربية

الشعر العربي الفصيح: النظام العروضي والأغراض

أسس علم العروض

علم العروض هو العلم الذي وضعه الخليل بن أحمد الفراهيدي (118-170 هـ / 736-786 م) لضبط أوزان الشعر العربي. يقوم هذا العلم على ثلاثة مفاهيم أساسية:

السبب الخفيف حرفان: الأول متحرك والثاني ساكن. مثل: مَنْ، هَلْ، قَدْ.

الوَدَّ المجموع ثلاثة أحرف: متحرك + متحرك + ساكن. مثل: فَعُو، قَفَا.

الوَدَّ المفروق ثلاثة أحرف: متحرك + ساكن + متحرك. مثل: مَفْعُ.

تتركب من هذه المكونات ثمانُ تفعيلاتٍ أساسية، ومن هذه التفعيلات تتشكل ستة عشر بحراً خليلياً.

البحور الخليلية الستة عشر

فيما يلي ملخص البحور الأكثر استخداماً مع أمثلتها:

البحر الطويل — أكثر البحور شيوعاً في الشعر العربي الكلاسيكي (أكثر من 40% من الديوان الشعري).
تفعيلاته: فَعُولُنْ مَفَاعِيلُنْ فَعُولُنْ مَفَاعِيلُنْ فِي كُلِّ شَطْرٍ.

مثال: قَفَا نَبْكَ مِنْ ذِكْرِي حَبِيبٍ وَمَنْزِلٍ — بِسِقْطِ اللَّوَى بَيْنَ الدَّخُولِ فَخَوْلِ
(امرؤ القيس، مطلع المعلقة)

البحر الكامل — ثالث البحور شيوعاً، متفعيلاته: مُتَفَاعِلُنْ مُتَفَاعِلُنْ مُتَفَاعِلُنْ. المتنبّي نظم أعظم قصائده على هذا البحر.

البحر البسيط — تفعيلاته: مُسْتَفْعِلُنْ فَاعِلُنْ مُسْتَفْعِلُنْ فَاعِلُنْ. يُسْتَعْمَدُ كَثِيراً فِي الرِّثَاءِ وَالْحِكْمَةِ.

نظام القافية

القافية في الشعر العربي الكلاسيكي ليست مجرد جناس صوتي في نهاية الشطر، بل هي منظومة دقيقة من الحروف والحركات:

الرَّوِّيُّ الحرف الأساسي للقافية؛ يحدد هوية القصيدة كلها.

الْوَصْل ما يلي الروي من هاء أو مدّ أو نون تنوين.
الرَّدْف مدّ يسبق الروي مباشرة (ألف أو واو أو ياء).
التَّأْسِيس ألف تفصلها عن الروي حرف واحد.

عيوب القافية الكبرى:

- الإيطاء: تكرار كلمة الروي نفسها في أكثر من بيت (أقبح العيوب).
- الإقواء: الخلط بين الكسرة والضمة على الروي.
- السناد: التناقض في الردف أو التأسيس بين الأبيات.

أغراض الشعر العربي الكلاسيكي

المدح – أعظم الأغراض وأوسعها في الشعر الكلاسيكي. يمر عبر ثلاث مراحل: النسيب (التمهيد)، ثم التخلص (الانتقال إلى الممدوح)، ثم جسم المدح (ذكر الكرم والشجاعة والحلم والعدل). قاعدة للذكاء الاصطناعي: يجب أن يعرف النظام بوضوح مَنْ يُمدَح ولأي صفات.

الهجاء – نقيض المدح؛ هجاء الأعداء وفضح عيوبهم. أهم أشكاله الخاصة: النقائص بين الشعراء؛ وفيها يجب أن يستخدم الشاعر الجيب نفس الوزن والقافية.

الغزل العذري – الحب العفيف المحتشم. يُحرّم فيه وصف جسد المحبوب. نماذجه: مجنون ليلى، جميل بثينة.

الغزل الحسي – الحب الجريء الصريح. مدرسة عمر بن أبي ربيعة المجازية. يُجيز وصف الجسد صراحة. الرثاء – الحزن على الميت مع تجميل مناقبه. الخنساء أعظم رثاءة في تاريخ الشعر العربي.

الزهد – التبرؤ من الدنيا والتزهد فيها. أبو العتاهية سيد هذا الغرض.

الخمريات – الاحتفاء بالخمير والشرب. أبو نواس إمامها. تنبيه للذكاء الاصطناعي: في الشعر الصوفي، لغة الخمير رمزية روحانية لا حرفية.

الشعر الصوفي – الشعر الروحاني والعرفاني. الخمير = المعرفة الإلهية؛ الساق = الشيخ أو الحق؛ السكر = حال الوجد.

الأشكال التناسية

المعارضة: قصيدة جديدة على نفس وزن وقافية قصيدة أخرى. القاعدة الذهبية: الوزن والروي واجبان لا خيار فيهما.

التشطير: أخذ قصيدة موجودة وإضافة شطر جديد قبل كل شطر من أشطارها الأصلية. الشروط:

السطور الأصلية لا تُعدّل، والسطور الجديدة على نفس الوزن.
التخميس: إضافة ثلاثة أسطار جديدة لكل بيت أصلي، لتصبح الوحدة خمسة أسطار (أبب - حج).
الأسطار الثلاثة الجديدة تتقافى فيما بينها بقافية مختلفة عن قافية القصيدة الأصلية.
إكمال القصيدة: إتمام قصيدة ناقصة. الشروط: الوزن والقافية والنبرة العاطفية ومستوى اللغة والكثافة
البلاغية كلها يجب أن تتطابق مع ما هو موجود.

Chapter 3

Dialectal and Nabati Poetry

Nabati poetry (الشعر النبطي) — also called “the people’s poetry” (شعر الشعب) — is the great vernacular literary tradition of the Arabian Peninsula. Composed in spoken Arabian dialects rather than Standard Arabic, it has maintained an unbroken oral tradition of at least six centuries while developing its own rigorous prosodic system parallel to (and partially derived from) the Khalilian system of classical Arabic.

3.1 Origins and Historical Development

The earliest documented Nabati poetry dates to the 14th century CE (referenced by Ibn Khaldun in his *Muqaddimah*, 1377). The tradition flowered from the 16th century onward as Arabian Peninsula dialects diverged increasingly from literary Arabic. Unlike classical poetry, which was composed for literate court audiences, Nabati poetry was composed by and for tribal Bedouin communities — often by unschooled poets who had absorbed prosodic intuitions from the oral environment rather than from formal study.

The name “Nabati” has contested etymology: some trace it to the ancient Nabataean Arabs; others argue it derives from نَبَط (to draw water from a well) — suggesting verse that “draws out” emotion. The term is now used without etymological weight simply to mean “Arabian Peninsula colloquial verse.”

3.1.1 Relationship to Khalilian Prosody

The Nabati prosodic system is **not a degenerate version of Khalilian prosody**. It is a parallel development within the same phonological family. Key differences:

- Nabati meters are realised through *colloquial phonology*: glottal stops replace hamzas; vowel shifts (e.g., قلب “heart” → غلب in Najdi) affect syllable lengths.

- The **dual-rhyme system** (a distinct rhyme for each hemistich) has no equivalent in classical poetry.
- Nabati meters permit more syllabic flexibility in the hashw (middle feet) than classical meters.
- Tashkeel (full diacritics) is less systematically applied to Nabati text — the phonological realisation is implicit in the dialect.

3.2 The Nabati Prosodic System

Nabati scholars have identified **twelve to fourteen** recognised meters (بحور نبطية), divided into **primary** (رئيسية) and **innovated** (مبتكرة) categories.

3.2.1 Primary Nabati Meters (البحور الرئيسية)

Table 3.1: Primary Nabati meters

Name	Arabic	Classical logue	Ana-	Rhyme Type	Use
Al-Hilali	الهلالي	Taweel variant		Single (classical)	All themes; oldest Nabati meter
Al-Sakhri	الصخري	Wafir		Single	Narrative, tribal history
Al-Hida'	الحداء	Rajaz		Single	Camel-driving, martial
Al-Rajad	الرجد	Mutadarak		Single	Light verse, songs
Al-Mashhub	المسحوب	Hilali-derived (shorter)		Dual	The dominant Nabati meter (>60%)
Al-Hijini	الهجينى	Sari'/Baseet mixed		Single	Camel-riding, journey verse

3.2.2 Innovated Nabati Meters (البحور المبتكرة)

Table 3.2: Innovated Nabati meters

Name	Arabic	Foot Pattern (approximate)	Associated Tradition
Al-Mashhub	المسحوب	مستفعلن مستفعلن فاعلاتن (each hemistich)	General / Samri
Bahr al-Samiri	بحر السامري	Linked to Mashhub; nocturnal gathering meter	Samri performance
Al-Zuhayri	الزهيري	مستفعلن فاعلن مستفعلن فاعل	Dense rhyming verse
Bahr al-Funun	بحر الفنون	فاعلاتن فاعلاتن فاعلن	Innovated by Ibn La'bun
Al-Murabbi'	المربع / المربع	4-line strophic; AAA-B rhyme	Muwashshahat-like forms
Al-Jinas	الجناس	Based on wordplay pat- terns	Occasional, humorous

3.3 The Dual-Rhyme System (نظام القافية المزدوجة)

The most distinctive feature of the Mashhub meter — and of the dominant strand of Nabati poetry — is the **dual-rhyme system**: each bayt has *two distinct rhyme letters*, one for the end of the first hemistich (الصدر) and a *different* one for the end of the second hemistich (العجز).

Rules of the Nabati Dual-Rhyme System

1. The **sadr rhyme** (قافية الصدر) applies consistently to all first hemistichs throughout the poem.
2. The **ajuz rhyme** (قافية العجز) applies consistently to all second hemistichs throughout the poem.
3. The two rhymes **must never converge** — if the sadr rhyme ends with ن (nun), the ajuz rhyme must not also end with ن. Convergence is considered a prosodic error in the Mashhub tradition.
4. The dual-rhyme system is **unique to Nabati poetry**; importing it into classical Fusha verse is an error.
5. Both rhymes must be internally consistent throughout the poem (no switching rawiy mid-poem).

يا صاحبي اللي يبالي بوالفي والقلب مني يتنى لقاكم
قافية الصدر: فاء (ي) قافية العجز: كاف (كم)

Example demonstrating dual rhyme: sadr rhyme on ف / ajuz rhyme on ك

3.4 The Hilali and Mashhub Meters in Detail

3.4.1 Al-Hilali (الهلالي)

The oldest documented Nabati meter, named for the Banu Hilal tribe. It is the ancestor of the Mashhub and uses a single (classical-style) rhyme.

Table 3.3: Al-Hilali meter structure

Hemistich pattern (approximate)	مستفعلن مستفعلن فاعلاتن (long form)
Rhyme type	Single rhyme (classical-style)
Association	Oldest Nabati poems; heroic/historical verse; tribal epics
Derivation	Related to classical Taweeel but realised through Najdi/Hijazi phonology
Modern use	Increasingly rare; considered archaic by contemporary Nabati poets

3.4.2 Al-Mashhub (المسحوب)

The dominant Nabati meter — over 60% of all Nabati poetry is in the Mashhub. Its name derives from **سَحَبَ** (to draw/pull) — referring to the way a singer “draws” the note along with the bow of the rababa (bowed string instrument).

Table 3.4: Al-Mashhub meter structure

Hemistich pattern	مُسْتَفْعِلُنْ مُسْتَفْعِلُنْ فَاعِلَاتُنْ
Derivation	Shortened from al-Hilali (one syllable shorter); emerged in the 12th century AH
Rhyme type	Dual rhyme (sadr rhyme ≠ ajuz rhyme) — mandatory
Associated tradition	The Samri nocturnal performance; general Nabati composition
Credit for innovation	Muhsin al-Hazani (محسن الحزاني) credited with formalising the Mashhub and dual-rhyme system in Samri tradition
Musical character	Designed for singing with melodic rababa accompaniment; the shortened final foot (فاعلاتن) creates the characteristic “pull” effect

AI Generation Rules for Al-Mashhub

1. Choose two *distinct* rhyme letters before generating — one for sadr, one for ajuz.
2. Apply the dual-rhyme constraint to every verse without exception.
3. The hemistich pattern مُسْتَفْعِلُنْ مُسْتَفْعِلُنْ فَاعِلَاتُنْ allows syllabic flexibility in the middle feet similar to classical Rajaz.
4. The final foot (فاعلاتن) must be respected — it carries the rhyme and the musical “resolution.”
5. Language must be in the appropriate Arabian Peninsula dialect — classical Fusha is a mismatch.

3.5 Nabati Poetic Purposes (أغراض الشعر النبطي)

Nabati poetry shares most classical أغراض but with a different emphasis and some unique categories:

Table 3.5: Nabati poetic purposes

Purpose	Arabic	Notes and Distinctives
Tribal Praise / Chivalry	شهادة وفروسية	The Nabati equivalent of madih; praises tribal leaders and warriors with focus on courage, hospitality
Love / Longing	غزل وشوق	More personal and direct than Udhri; often expresses separation from the tribe or homeland
Elegy	رثاء	Mourning for tribe members; loss of companions in the desert
Wisdom	حكمة	Bedouin wisdom verses; proverbs in metered form
Boasting / Pride	نفر	Tribal pride; glorification of the tribe's history and lineage
Camel-Driver's Call	الخداء	A working genre: verse composed to set the rhythm of camel travel; one of the oldest Nabati purposes
Separation / Homeland	شعر الفراق والحنين	Intense longing for the homeland and tribe; especially common in exile verse
Tribal Challenge	التحدي القبلي	Direct tribal-vs-tribal competition; higher personal stakes than classical هجاء
Social Satire	هجاء شعبي	Sharp but less courtly than classical هجاء; often humorous

3.6 Regional Varieties of Dialectal Poetry

3.6.1 Najdi Poetry (الشعر النجدي)

The heartland of Nabati tradition. Characterised by:

- Heavy use of the Mashhub meter with its characteristic dual-rhyme system.
- Vocabulary drawn from Najdi dialect: phonological features include $ج \rightarrow ي$ in some regions (e.g., الريل for الرجل).
- Strong association with the Samri performance tradition.
- Famous poets: Muhsin al-Hazani, Rakan ibn Hidhlin (راكبان بن حثلين), Hamad ibn Labun (حمد بن لعبون).

3.6.2 Hijazi Poetry (الشعر المجازي)

The Hijaz (Mecca, Medina, Taif, Jeddah) has a distinct tradition:

- The Muhawara / Qalta improvised dueling tradition is strongest here.
- Hijazi poets consider their tradition of poetic improvisation (المحاورَة) more refined and ancient than the Gulf version (القلطة).
- Vocabulary: Hijazi dialect features including أنا → أُنَا (no guttural shift) and specific lexical items.

3.6.3 Gulf Poetry (الشعر الخليجي)

The Gulf states (Kuwait, UAE, Qatar, Bahrain) share the Nabati tradition with Najd but with local phonological and lexical features:

- Gulf dialect phonology: ك → چ (ch) in some positions; ق → گ (g).
- The Samri tradition is also strong in Kuwait and Bahrain.
- Contemporary Gulf poets have taken Nabati verse to a mass broadcast audience through television programs.

3.7 Famous Nabati Poets

Table 3.6: Landmark Nabati poets

Poet	Arabic	Era	Contribution
Muhammad ibn Labun	محمد بن لعبون	18th c.	Foundational Samri poet; innovated Bahr al-Funun
Muhsin al-Hazani	محسن الحزاني	19th c.	Formalised Mashhub + dual-rhyme for Samri
Rakan ibn Hidhlin	راكان بن حثلين	19th c.	Tribal warrior poet; epic Hilali verse
Hamad ibn Hidhlin	حمد بن حثلين	19th–20th c.	Political and tribal verse
Muhammad ibn Shafi	محمد بن شافي	20th c.	Major neo-Nabati voice
Ghazi al-Gosaibi	غازي القصيبي	1940–2010	Bridged Nabati and classical; most widely read modern Saudi poet
Badr ibn Abd al-Muhsin	بدر بن عبدالمحسن	b. 1949	Contemporary; dominant voice in Mashhub

3.8 AI Implementation Notes for Nabati Poetry

Implementation Note**Key implementation differences between Nabati and Classical:**

1. **Language detection:** The system must identify the dialect (Najdi, Hijazi, Gulf) from the user's request before selecting vocabulary. Using Fusha vocabulary in a Nabati poem is a category error.
2. **Dual-rhyme enforcement:** For the Mashhub meter, both rhyme letters must be selected and tracked separately. The classical qafiya evaluator cannot be applied to Mashhub verse.
3. **Prosodic validation:** Nabati meters cannot be validated using the Khalilian bohour library. A separate Nabati prosody module (or LLM-based evaluation with Nabati-specific prompts) is required.
4. **Tashkeel:** Full tashkeel is less critical in Nabati than in classical poetry, because syllable lengths are determined by dialect phonology. However, tashkeel is still useful for clarifying the intended pronunciation for prosodic scanning.
5. **Meter selection:** Mashhub is the default for general requests. Hilali should be specified explicitly; it is perceived as more archaic and solemn.

النسخة العربية

الشعر العامي والشعر النبطي

الشعر النبطي: تعريفه وأصوله

الشعر النبطي هو الشعر العامي للجزيرة العربية؛ ينظم باللهجات المحكية – النجدية والحجازية والخليجية واليمينية – لا بالفصحى. وهو تقليد أدبي راسخ يمتد على الأقل ستة قرون، ويحظى بجمهور شعبي واسع في المملكة العربية السعودية ودول الخليج.

الشعر النبطي ليس انحداً عن الشعر الفصحى، بل هو نظام عروضي مستقل نما في نفس البيئة الصوتية الخليلية، غير أنه وُضع بصورة مستقلة عبر التقليد الشفهي القبلي.

أبرز خصائص الشعر النبطي

1. اللغة العامية: يُستخدم معجم اللهجة المحلية (النجدية أو الحجازية أو الخليجية)، لا الفصحى.
2. القافية المزدوجة: الخاصية الأبرز في بحر المسحوب؛ لكل شطر (الصدر والعجز) قافية مستقلة، ويشترط ألا تتقاطع القافيتان.
3. البحور النبطية الخاصة: اثنا عشر بحراً على الأقل، أشهرها: الهلالي، والمسحوب، والهجين، والسامري، والزهيري.
4. الارتباط بالأداء: الشعر النبطي في الأصل شفهي موسيقي؛ أغلبه يُغنى مع الربابة أو الطبول.

بحر المسحوب

بحر المسحوب هو أكثر بحور الشعر النبطي استخداماً (أكثر من 60% من المنظوم). اسمه مشتق من “سحب” النعمة مع قوس الربابة أثناء الغناء.

تفعيلاته التقريبية: مُسْتَفْعِلُنْ مُسْتَفْعِلُنْ فَاعِلَاتُنْ في كل شطر.
نظام القافية المزدوجة في المسحوب:

- قافية الصدر (نهاية الشطر الأول) لها حرف روي خاص بها.
- قافية العجز (نهاية الشطر الثاني) لها حرف روي مختلف.
- يجب أن لا يتطابق حرفا الروي طوال القصيدة كلها.

• الخلط بين القافيتين أو توحيدهما خطأ عروضي في المسحوب.

مثال: يَا صَاحِبِي اللَّيْلُ يُبَالِي بِوَالِفِي — وَالْقَلْبُ مِنِّي يَتَمَنَّى لِقَاكَ (قافية الصدر: الفاء — قافية العجز: الكاف)

أغراض الشعر النبطي

الشهامة والفروسية مدح القادة القبليين وفروسيتهم؛ نظير المديح الفصيح لكنه أكثر ارتباطاً بالحياة القبلية. الغزل والشوق الغزل في الشعر النبطي أكثر مباشرة وشخصية من الغزل الفصيح. الحنين والفراق الشوق إلى الأهل والوطن والقبيلة؛ من أكثر الأغراض التعبيراً في الشعر النبطي. الحداء الحداء هو شعر سوق الإبل؛ شعر وظيفي يضبط إيقاع المسيرة. التحدي القبلي تنافس مباشر بين قبيلتين شعرياً؛ أكثر حدةً وشخصية من هجاء الشعر الكلاسيكي.

قواعد الذكاء الاصطناعي للشعر النبطي

- تحديد اللهجة أولاً: النجدية أم الحجازية أم الخليجية.
- اختيار حرفي القافية قبل بدء التوليد (للمسحوب).
- لا يصلح تطبيق محقق العروض الخليلي على الشعر النبطي؛ يحتاج إلى نظام تقييم مستقل.
- إذا طلب المستخدم قصيدة نبطية دون تحديد البحر، يُفترض افتراضياً المسحوب.

Chapter 4

Performance Poetry Forms

Performance poetry (الشعر الأدائي) designates forms in which the compositional and performative acts are inseparable — where the context of delivery (a dueling stage, a tribal gathering, a dance circle) is built into the rules of the form itself. This chapter covers four major traditions: improvised poetic dueling (المحاورة / القلطة), the Southern Ardah (العرضة الجنوبية), the Samri nocturnal tradition (السامري), and the Levantine Zajal (الزجل).

4.1 شعر المحاورة والقلطة — Improvised Poetic Dueling

4.1.1 Definition and Regional Names

المحاورة (“the conversation”) and القلطة (“the advance/challenge”) refer to the *same artistic tradition* under different regional names:

Table 4.1: Regional names for improvised poetic dueling

Region	Name Used	Notes
Hijaz (Mecca, Medina, Jeddah)	المحاورة / الرد / الرديح	الرديح is considered the oldest form name; الرد is common
Najd / Gulf	القلطة	From قلط على = “to advance toward someone”; the challenge posture
Eastern Arabia	الرديّة	Also used: القلطة
Tihama coast	الرد	Generic; also improvised

4.1.2 The Core Mechanics

المحاورة / القلطة is improvised, metered, rhymed poetry recited as a *real-time duel* between two poets before a live audience. The defining characteristics:

1. **Complete improvisation:** No pre-writing or preparation is permitted. The challenge to the tradition's integrity is the *spontaneity* of composition. A poet who has written their verses in advance has violated the spirit of the form.
2. **Musical delivery:** Verses are not recited but *sung* to a specific melodic path (طريق).
3. **Audience participation:** Audience members (or a chorus group, الصفوف) repeat verses or provide rhythmic support.

4.1.3 The Tariq System (نظام الطريق)

In المحاورة, the meter is not specified as a Khalilian or Nabati bahr but as a طريق ("path" or "melody-meter"). The tariq determines:

- The prosodic foot structure
- The melody used for singing
- The pace and rhythm of the exchange

Both poets are *bound to the same tariq* for the duration of the exchange. A poet who breaks the tariq loses the round.

4.1.4 The Opening and Response Structure

الفتح / الفتل **The opening move:** The first poet introduces an argument, image, or challenge in verse. This must be metrically and melodically correct.

النقض / الرد **The response:** The second poet must *immediately* counter — accepting or refuting the argument in metrically matching verse. The quality of response is judged on: speed, prosodic accuracy, the cleverness of the counter-argument, and the power of the imagery.

4.1.5 Evaluation Criteria

A محاورة exchange is judged — by critics, by fellow poets, and by the audience — on:

1. **Prosodic accuracy:** Both poets must maintain meter and rhyme precisely.
2. **Speed of response:** Hesitation is a sign of weakness.

3. **Argument quality:** The response must *engage* with the specific claim or image of the preceding verse — not just add a new independent verse.
4. **Imagery:** Striking metaphors and unexpected comparisons score highly.
5. **Audience reaction:** The audience's spontaneous response (applause, repetition of the verse) is itself a form of judgment.

4.1.6 Types of محاورة

الفاضلة *Noble/elevated exchange:* Addresses high literary, ethical, or social themes. More dignified tone.

الفضولية *Tribal/popular exchange:* Involves direct personal and tribal challenge; more aggressive.

AI Generation Rules for المحاورة

1. The system must simulate the exchange: given the first poet's verse, generate a valid counter-verse.
2. The counter-verse **must use the same tariq (meter + rhyme)** as the opening verse.
3. The counter-verse must **engage with the specific argument** of the opening — not simply add a new theme.
4. Language must be in the appropriate regional dialect (Hijazi for محاورة, Najdi for قلطة).
5. The response should exhibit براعة الارتجال: wit, speed of thought, and surprise.
6. For a full simulated exchange: generate multiple rounds (minimum 3 exchanges) maintaining prosodic consistency throughout.

4.2 العرضة الجنوبية — The Southern Ardah

4.2.1 Definition and Origins

Al-Ardah al-Janubiyya (العرضة الجنوبية) is a martial performance poetry tradition from the southern Saudi regions: Asir (عسير), Jizan (جازان), Najran (نجران), and Al-Bahah (الباحة). At least four centuries old, it originated as a martial display (عرض عسكري) designed to mobilise fighters and demonstrate tribal unity before battle.

4.2.2 The Performance Structure

The Ardah is a precisely choreographed performance:

1. **Formation:** Participants stand in **two parallel rows facing each other**, with approximately two metres between the rows.
2. **The central poet:** One or more poets (شاعر العرضة) stand in the *space between the two rows*.
3. **Delivery:** The poet turns to the first row and recites the *sadr* (first hemistich) of a verse; then turns to the second row and delivers the *ajuz* (second hemistich).
4. **Collective chant:** Both rows repeat the verse in unison (الإنشاد الجماعي).
5. **Multi-poet exchange:** In elaborate performances, multiple poets (sometimes four) engage in محاورة between the rows.
6. **Instruments:** The زبر (a percussion instrument) provides the rhythmic pulse; sometimes drums (طبول) are added.
7. **Props:** Participants traditionally carry swords, daggers, or rifles.

4.2.3 Poetic Characteristics of the Ardah

- Poems are typically **short** — often not exceeding ten verses.
- Language is in the **colloquial Arabic of the southern regions** (Asiri, Jizan dialects).
- The primary meter historically was rhymed stanzas (أبيات مقفأة). Over two centuries ago, poets transitioned to what is known as شعر الشقر (a specific southern regional form with its own rules).
- **Themes:** tribal pride (نفر), martial enthusiasm (حماسة), heroism (بطولة), and historical tribal epics.

4.2.4 Historical Forms of the Ardah

Three historical types of Ardah existed:

عرضة الحرب *War Ardah:* Performed before battle; specific drum rhythm; only warriors going into battle participate.

عرضة الخروج *Departure Ardah:* Performed in a straight line, two rows moving forward; short poetic phrases.

عرضة الدخول *Entrance Ardah:* Performed entering a village; used for welcoming guests or celebrating returning warriors.

AI Generation Rules for the Ardah

1. The system must know the **occasion** (battle eve, tribal celebration, historical performance) to set the correct tone.
2. Language must be in the **southern Saudi dialects** (Asiri/Jizan/Najrani), not Najdi or Gulf Arabic.
3. Poems should be short (4–10 verses) and each verse must be *self-contained in meaning* to enable collective repetition.
4. The sadr/ajuz structure must be particularly clear — the two rows must be able to grasp and repeat each hemistich immediately.
5. Themes: martial pride (حماسة) and tribal solidarity (وحدة قبلية) are primary; love poetry is inappropriate for Ardah.
6. If generating شعر الشقر, apply the specific meter and rhyme patterns of that form.

4.3 السامري — The Samri Tradition

4.3.1 Definition and Origins

Samri (السامري) is a folkloric music, poetry, and dance tradition from Najd, Saudi Arabia, approximately 300 years old. Its name derives from السمر (staying up late at night in conversation and entertainment) — it is intrinsically a **nocturnal** art form, performed at evening and night-time gatherings.

4.3.2 The Performance Structure

1. **Formation:** Two opposing rows of men face each other, seated on their knees.
2. **Synchronized movement:** Men sway, clap, and sing in synchrony — the bodily movement is as important as the verse.
3. **Al-Muallim (المعلم):** A master teacher-vocalist leads the group by *teaching successive verses in real time*. This is the Samri equivalent of the شاعر العرضة.
4. **Call-and-response:** One group *opens* (يشيل) with a verse; the opposing group gives the *mard* (المرد) — repetition/response.
5. **Opening chants:** The performance begins with الوائين (opening chants) establishing the melodic foundation.

4.3.3 Poetic Content

- Samri is built on **Nabati (colloquial) poetry**, specifically using the **Mashhub meter** with its dual-rhyme system.
- **بحر السامري** is also recognised as a distinct meter in the Nabati system.
- The poetry centres on works by foundational poets: Muhammad ibn Labun and Muhsin al-Hazani.
- Muhsin al-Hazani is credited with introducing the Mashhub meter to Samri poetry and formalising the dual-rhyme system for musical performance.
- Contemporary Samri performances include modern Nabati poetry on personal and emotional themes.

4.3.4 Instruments

Table 4.2: Samri instruments

Instrument	Arabic	Role
Al-Tar / Al-Tabl	الطار / الطبل	Main hand drum; provides the rhythmic pulse
Al-Mirjaf	المرجاف	Large frame drum; produces deep tones
Al-Mard	المرد	Small response drum
Al-Daf	الدف	Standard frame drum

4.3.5 Regional Samri Styles

Table 4.3: Regional Samri variations

Region	Characteristics
Aniza / Qassim	Heaviest, most technically demanding; considered the canonical form
Duwasir (southern Najd)	Both heavy and light variants; faster tempos
Coastal regions	Heavier percussion, slower pacing
Hail	Emphasises poetic content over musical elaboration

AI Generation Rules for Samri Poetry

1. Samri poetry uses the **Mashhub meter** — the dual-rhyme constraint is mandatory.
2. Verses must be **short and rhythmically clear** for group chanting — long complex sentences are inappropriate.
3. Language: Central/Northern Najdi dialect.
4. Themes: Love, longing, tribal camaraderie, nocturnal gathering mood — not war or formal praise.
5. The **وانين** opening is a distinct structural element: a melodic phrase without full lexical content that sets the musical key.
6. Each verse must be *complete and repeatable* — the opposite row must be able to chant it without knowing the next verse.

4.4 الزجل — The Zajal

4.4.1 Definition and Origins

Zajal (الزجل) is colloquial, strophic, semi-improvised oral poetry originating in al-Andalus and still vigorously alive in Lebanon, Syria, Palestine, and Egypt. The earliest documented Zajal poet was Ibn Quzman of Cordoba (1078–1160). The form reached the Levant and Egypt in the 13th–14th centuries following the Reconquista. The name derives from زَجَلَ — to raise the voice in song or to shout joyfully.

4.4.2 Structural Characteristics

Unlike classical poetry's monorhyme structure, Zajal is **strophic**: each stanza has an internal rhyme pattern. The most common Zajal structure is the **qasida zajal** form:

- **Al-Matla'** (المطلع): Opening couplet establishing the main rhyme (AA).
- **Al-Qafla** (القفلة): A refrain (the same rhyme as the matla') that recurs at the end of each stanza.
- **Al-Dour** (الدور): The body stanzas, each with an internal rhyme (BB, CC...) before returning to the qafla.

A stanza of three dour lines + one qafla line = the **murabba'** form (4-line strophe), the most common Zajal unit.

4.4.3 Lebanese Zajal Forms

A Lebanese Zajal evening (ليلة زجلية) typically progresses through:

القصيدَة Formal ode recitation to open the evening.

المعنى والقريدي Popular debate structures; the dominant form. Includes sub-variants like **المونخس المردود**.

الغزل Love-lyric forms including **الموشحات** variants — joyful, flirtatious.

الشروقي Concluding love-lament form.

4.4.4 The Zajal Dueling Format

Lebanese Zajal is primarily a **competitive duel** (مجادلة زجلية) between two or more **زجالين** (Zajal poets):

1. Poets improvise verses on the same topic and in the same form.
2. A crucial rule: when a poet responds, they **must begin with the last word** of the previous poet's stanza.
3. The exchange is accompanied by percussion (tambourines, **رق**) and sometimes a ney flute.
4. A chanting chorus (**الكورس**) repeats verses and refrains.

4.4.5 Metrical System

Zajal uses two distinct metrical systems in parallel:

Quantitative Based on Khalilian classical meters (e.g., **المعنى** and some forms scan according to Sari', Rajaz, Wafir).

Stress-syllabic Based on Syriac/Aramaic metrics (e.g., many sub-forms of the **القريدي**).

AI Generation Rules for Zajal

1. The system must identify the **specific Zajal form** (Lebanese, Egyptian, Moroccan) and the **dialect** to be used.
2. Apply the **strophic structure**: matla' → dour stanzas → recurring qafla.
3. For dueling format: the response poet's stanza *must begin with the last word of the previous stanza*.
4. Language must be the appropriate colloquial dialect (Lebanese Arabic for Lebanese Zajal, Egyptian for Egyptian, etc.).
5. The matla' rhyme is the binding constant of the entire poem — it must be maintained precisely.
6. Zajal permits stress-syllabic meters not found in Khalilian prosody — do not attempt to validate Zajal with the classical bohaur library.

4.5 Other Performance Forms

4.5.1 الحداء — The Camel-Driver's Call

Al-Hida' (الحداء) is one of the oldest Arabic poetic forms — verse composed and sung during camel travel to set the pace and sustain morale. It uses the Rajaz meter (or its Nabati equivalent, Bahr al-Hida'). Characteristics:

- Short, simple, highly rhythmic — designed to synchronise with the camel's gait.
- Often improvised on the spot.
- Themes: encouragement, journey, longing for the destination.

4.5.2 الموال / المواليا — The Mawwal

The mawwal (الموال) is a popular solo singing form in Levantine and Egyptian traditions, typically in 4 or 7 lines with a complex rhyme scheme that incorporates word-play (جناس). The Nabati equivalent was introduced c. 1411 AH with a 3-line stanza featuring melodic complexity.

النسخة العربية

أشكال الشعر الأدائي

شعر المحاورة والقلطة

المحاورة (في الحجاز) والقلطة (في نجد والخليج) اسمان لفن واحد: هو الشعر الارتجالي التنافسي بين شاعرَيْن أمام جمهور حيّ. يقوم الشاعران بتبادل الأبيات المرتجلة على نفس الطريق (الوزن والنغم) – وهو أشبه بمبارزة فكرية شعرية.

قواعد المحاورة:

1. الارتجال التام: يُحرّم الاستعداد المسبق؛ القيمة الفنية تكمن في العفوية.
 2. الالتزام بالطريق (الوزن والنغم) طوال المباراة.
 3. كل بيت إجابة يجب أن يُعالج حجة الشاعر السابق، لا مجرد إضافة موضوع جديد.
 4. من لم يستطع الرد سريعاً هُزم.
- قواعد الذكاء الاصطناعي: لتوليد رد المحاورة، يجب على النظام: (1) الحفاظ على نفس الطريق، (2) معالجة الحجة الشعرية السابقة مباشرة، (3) استخدام اللهجة المحلية المناسبة (المجازية أو النجدية).

العرضة الجنوبية

العرضة الجنوبية فن أدائي من مناطق عسير وجازان ونجران والباحة. يقف المشاركون في صفّين متقابلين، ويقف الشاعر في المنتصف بين الصفين يُلقى صدر البيت تجاه الصف الأول وعجزه تجاه الصف الثاني، ثم يُرددان معاً.

خصائص شعر العرضة:

- قصائد قصيرة (4-10 أبيات عادةً).
- اللغة من لهجات المنطقة الجنوبية (العسيرة والجيزانية).
- الموضوعات: الفخر والحماسة والبطولة والتاريخ القبلي.
- كل بيت يجب أن يكون مكتفياً بنفسه لأن الجمهور يُردده.

السامري

السامري فن ليلي نجدى عمره نحو ثلاثمئة عام. يجلس الرجال في صفين متقابلين، يتمايلون ويصفقون وينشدون الشعر النبطي (في الغالب على بحر المسحوب) مع المعلم الذي يُعلمهم الأبيات أولاً بأول. أبرز شعراء السامري: محمد بن لعبون ومحسن الحزاني الذي وضع نظام القافية المزدوجة في السامري.

قواعد الذكاء الاصطناعي للسامري:

- استخدام بحر المسحوب مع القافية المزدوجة.
- أبيات قصيرة واضحة الإيقاع لتمكين الإنشاد الجماعي.
- اللهجة النجدية الوسطى/الشمالية.
- الموضوعات: الحب والحنين والسمر والرفقة — لا الحرب ولا المديح الرسمي.

الزجل

الزجل فن الشعر العامي المتقنى في البلاد الشامية ومصر والمغرب. أقدم زجال موثق هو ابن قزمان الأندلسي (1078-1160م). في الزجل اللباني، يتنافس شاعران أو أكثر بارتجال الأبيات على نفس الموضوع. القاعدة الذهبية: الشاعر المجيب يجب أن يبدأ مقطعه بآخر كلمة في مقطع الشاعر السابق.

الشكل البنائي للزجل:

- المطلع: بيتان يُثبتان القافية الأساسية (أأ).
- القفلة: لازمة تعود في نهاية كل مقطع على نفس قافية المطلع.
- الدور: مقاطع الجسم، لكل مقطع قافية داخلية خاصة (بب، جج...) قبل العودة للقفلة.

Chapter 5

Modern Arabic Poetry Forms

The mid-twentieth century brought a revolution to Arabic poetry that severed — or at least dramatically loosened — the bond between poetry and the classical prosodic system. Two new forms emerged: *shi'r al-tafila* (شعر التفعيلة), which retains classical meter but abandons the fixed two-hemistich line; and *qasidat al-nathr* (قصيدة النثر), which abandons both meter and rhyme in favour of concentrated prose-rhythm. Understanding these forms is essential for **The Poet** because they are widely requested and their evaluation criteria differ fundamentally from classical and Nabati poetry.

5.1 شعر التفعيلة — Metrical Free Verse

5.1.1 Historical Origins

The emergence of شعر التفعيلة is dated to December 1947, when the Iraqi poet **Nazik al-Mala'ika** (نازك الملائكة, 1923–2007) published her poem “Cholera” (الكوليرا) in the Lebanese journal *al-Uruba*. The poem used classical metrical feet (تفعيلات) but in lines of variable length — a radical departure from the fixed-line bayt.

The Iraqi poet **Badr Shakir al-Sayyab** (بدر شاكر السياب, 1926–1964) published “Was It About Love?” at nearly the same time and is co-credited as founder. Other early pioneers: **Abd al-Wahhab al-Bayati** and **Shathel Taqa**. Nazik al-Mala'ika later theorised the form in her landmark study *Issues of Modern Poetry* (قضايا الشعر المعاصر, 1962).

Major later poets: Fadwa Tuqan, Adonis, Mahmoud Darwish, Amal Dunqul, Ahmad Abd al-Mu'ti Hijazi, Samih al-Qasim.

5.1.2 Structural Rules

Defining Characteristics of شعر التفعيلة

1. **Retains classical quantitative meter:** The poem is built on one chosen Khalilian bahr's *tafila* (foot). Valid choices: Kamil, Mutaqarib, Ramal, Wafir, Hazaj, Baseet.
2. **Variable line length:** Each line (سطر) may contain one, two, three, or more iterations of the chosen foot — the number is determined by the poem's meaning and emotion, not by a fixed scheme.
3. **Rhyme is optional:** Rhyme may appear but is never enforced. When it appears, it is selective (not monorhyme). End-rhyme is possible but not mandatory.
4. **The satra (line) replaces the bayt:** The unit of composition is the line (السطر), which can be short (one foot) or long (many feet). Lines are not paired into hemistichs.
5. **The tafilā is the binding element:** The poem's internal musicality comes from the repeated foot, not from structural regularity.

5.1.3 Meter Selection in شعر التفعيلة

Not all meters work equally well in شعر تفعيلة poetry. Nazik al-Mala'ika and other theorists observed:

Table 5.1: Meter suitability for شعر التفعيلة

Meter	Suitability	Notes
الكامل (Kamel)	Excellent	The most emotionally versatile; used extensively by Darwish
المتقارب (Mutakareb)	Excellent	Light, flowing; used by al-Sayyab in epic poems
الرمل (Ramal)	Very good	Lyrical, melancholic
الوافر (Wafir)	Good	Emotional depth
الهزج (Hazaj)	Good	Musical, light
البسيط (Baseet)	Moderate	Heavier feel; less common in شعر تفعيلة
الطويل (Taweel)	Difficult	The long complex feet create monotony at variable lengths
الرجز (Rajaz)	Special case	Accepted in didactic/experimental شعر تفعيلة

5.1.4 Al-Sayyab's "Rain Song" — A Reference Example

Badr Shakir al-Sayyab's "Unshoudat al-Matar" (أنشودة المطر) is the canonical example of *شعر التفعيلة* poetry. It uses the **Kamel meter** (مُتَفَاعِلُنْ) with variable line lengths:

عَيْنَاكَ غَابَتَا نَحِيلِ سَاعَةَ السَّحَرِ
أَوْ شُرْفَتَانِ رَاحَ يَنَآى عَنْهُمَا الْقَمَرُ
عَيْنَاكَ حِينَ تَبْتَسِمَانِ تُورِقُ الْكُرُومُ
وَتَرْقُصُ الْأَضْوَاءُ كَالْأَقْفَارِ فِي نَهْرٍ
يَهْزُهُ الْمَجْدَافُ وَهَنَا سَاعَةَ السَّحَرِ

Al-Sayyab, "Rain Song" (opening) — Kamel meter, variable line lengths

5.1.5 Evaluation Criteria for شعر التفعيلة

The evaluator must check:

1. **Metrical consistency:** Every line must be constructible from valid iterations of the chosen foot, allowing standard zehafs.
2. **Rhyme logic** (if present): If the poet has introduced rhyme, it should be consistent within its pattern — not random.
3. **Internal rhythm:** Even without fixed line length, the poem should have a sense of rhythmic flow — varying line lengths deliberately for effect.
4. **Imagery quality:** The standard for modern poetry is judged heavily by imagery, metaphor, and emotional resonance.
5. **Lineation logic:** Line breaks should be meaningful — not arbitrary. A line should break where a musical or semantic beat falls.

Implementation Note

For AI validation of شعر التفعيلة: the classical prosody library (bohoul) can be applied at the level of individual lines rather than bayt pairs. Each line must scan as a valid sequence of the chosen tafila with allowed zehafs. Line pairs do not need to match each other's length.

5.2 قصيدة النثر — The Prose Poem

5.2.1 Historical Origins and Theoretical Grounding

قصيدة النثر completely abandons both meter and rhyme. It was theoretically launched in 1960 through two simultaneous landmark texts:

- **Adonis** (أدونيس, Ali Ahmad Sa'id Esber): published "On the Prose Poem" (في قصيدة النثر), proclaiming it "a distinctive artistic construction with its own identity."
- **Unsi al-Hajj** (أنسي الحاج): published his collection *Lan* (لن) with a seminal theoretical introduction — the first use of قصيدة النثر as a formal category.

Both texts drew theoretical inspiration from Suzanne Bernard's 1959 French study of the prose poem. The institutional home was **Majallat Shi'r** (مجلة شعر — "Poetry Magazine"), founded in Beirut in 1957 by Yusuf al-Khal (يوسف الخال).

Nazik al-Mala'ika — who championed تنغيلة poetry — actively *opposed* the prose poem, viewing it as either a misnomer or incompetent verse. This opposition is itself important context: the prose poem poses a radical challenge to the definition of Arabic poetry as "metered and rhymed speech" (كلام موزون مقفى).

5.2.2 Defining Characteristics

What Makes a قصيدة نثر

1. **No quantitative meter:** The text cannot be divided into classical feet.
2. **No rhyme:** End-rhyme is absent (though internal assonance may exist).
3. **Concentrated language:** Dense imagery, high semantic load per word.
4. **Internal rhythm:** The "music" comes from rhythm of syntax, repetition patterns, vowel/consonant textures — not prosodic pattern.
5. **Unity:** A prose poem is shorter than conventional prose; it has a single emotional or conceptual arc.
6. **Distinctness from prose:** The text is richer in imagery and denser in language than ordinary literary prose.

5.2.3 Evaluation Criteria for قصيدة نثر

Evaluation of prose poetry cannot rely on prosodic validation. Criteria:

Table 5.2: Prose poem evaluation dimensions

Dimension	Criteria
Imagery density	Are the images fresh and unexpected? Is there metaphoric depth?
Language concentration	Every word should be load-bearing; padding/fillers are defects.
Internal rhythm	Syntactic patterns, deliberate repetition, and phonological texture create rhythm.
Emotional arc	Does the poem have a beginning, development, and resolution — even if non-narrative?
Distinctness from prose	Is this genuinely “poetic” — or just paragraph writing?
Unity	Is there a single governing image or concept that holds the piece together?

Implementation Note

For AI generation of قصيدة نثر: the system should use a different prompt paradigm than for classical/Nabati poetry. No tafeelat, no rhyme constraints. The generation goal is: concentrated imagery + emotional arc + language density. The evaluator cannot use the bohaur library — it should use LLM-based quality assessment only.

5.3 Mixing Traditions (التمزيج بين التقاليد)

Modern Arabic poets frequently work at the intersection of traditions. Some patterns:

- **Neo-classical (الإحيائي)**: Classical meters and forms but modern content. Ahmad Shawqi (“the Prince of Poets”) and Hafiz Ibrahim. This is technically still “classical” in the system’s taxonomy.
- **Romantic (الرومانسي)**: Influenced by Western Romanticism; uses classical forms but with freer imagery and more personal emotional content. Khalil Gibran’s Arabic prose poetry; the Mahjar school.
- **Engaged poetry (الشعر الملتزم)**: Political and social commitment fused with modern forms. Mahmoud Darwish (Palestine), Nizar Qabbani (Syria — who used classical meters for provocative modern content), Amal Dunqul.
- **Hybrid classical/Nabati**: Some contemporary poets compose in both tradi-

tions, or use Nabati meters with Fusha language. This is technically non-standard but requested.

Table 5.3: Modern Arabic poetry tradition overview for AI

Form	Meter?	Rhyme?	AI Evaluation Approach
Classical qasida	Yes (Khalilian)	Yes (monorhyme)	Bohour library + qafiya rules
Neo-classical	Yes (Khalilian)	Yes	Same as classical
شعر التفعيلة	Yes (single foot)	Optional	Bohour library per-line
قصيدة النثر	No	No	LLM qualitative only
Nabati (Mashhub)	Yes (Nabati)	Yes (dual)	Nabati-specific rules
Zajal	Yes (stress-syllabic)	Yes (strophic)	Form-specific rules

النسخة العربية

الأشكال الشعرية الحديثة

شعر التفعيلة

ظهر شعر التفعيلة في العراق أواخر الأربعينيات من القرن العشرين. تُنسب ريادته إلى نازك الملائكة (1923-2007) التي نشرت قصيدة "الكوليرا" في ديسمبر 1947، وإلى بدر شاكر السياب (1926-1964) الذي نشر قصيدة "هل كان حباً؟" في نفس الفترة تقريباً.

مبادئ شعر التفعيلة:

1. يحتفظ بالبحر الخليلية (تفعيلاتها)، لكن يتخلى عن الشطرين الثابتين الطول.
 2. الوحدة هي السطر (السطر) لا البيت؛ وطول السطر متغير حسب المعنى والإيقاع.
 3. القافية اختيارية وليست ملزمة؛ إذا وجدت فهي انتقائية لا متواترة.
 4. التفعيلة المختارة هي العمود الفقري الموسيقي للقصيدة.
- أفضل البحور لشعر التفعيلة: الكامل (محمود درويش) والمتقارب (السياب في قصائده الملحمية) والرمال والوافر.
- قواعد تقييم الذكاء الاصطناعي: يتحقق النظام من أن كل سطر يتكون من تكرارات صحيحة للتفعيلة المختارة بزحافات المسموحة — لكنه لا يشترط تساوي أطوال الأسطر.
- مثال (من "أنشودة المطر" للسياب على بحر الكامل): عَيْنَاكَ غَابَتَا نَحِيلُ سَاعَةَ السَّحَرِ — أَوْ شُرْفَتَانِ رَاحَ يَنَآئِ عَنْهُمَا الْقَمَرُ

قصيدة النثر

قصيدة النثر تتخلى كلياً عن الوزن والقافية. أطلقها نظرياً أدونيس وأنسي الحاج عام 1960 في مجلة "شعر" البيروتية.

ما يميز قصيدة النثر عن النثر العادي:

- كثافة الصور الشعرية وثقل الدلالة في كل كلمة.
- إيقاع داخلي ناتج عن بنية الجملة والتكرار والتوازي اللفظي.
- وحدة موضوعية أو صورية تجمع القصيدة.
- إيجاز لا يتاح للنثر الاعتيادي.

قواعد تقييم الذكاء الاصطناعي: لا يُطبَّق النظام العروضي؛ يُستخدم تقييم نوعي مبني على الذكاء الاصطناعي يرصد: كثافة الصور، عمق المجاز، الإيقاع الداخلي، القوس العاطفي، والكثافة اللغوية.

التمزج بين التقاليد

بعض الأنماط الشعرية الحديثة تجمع بين التقاليد:

الإحيائي شعراء النهضة كأحمد شوقي وحافظ إبراهيم: مضمون حديث في قوالب كلاسيكية.
الرومانسي مدرسة المهجر (جبران خليل جبران): نثر شعري يمزج العربية بالرومانسية الغربية.
الملتزم محمود درويش ونزار قباني وأمل دنقل: التزام سياسي واجتماعي في أشكال حديثة.

Appendix A

Complete Meter Reference

This appendix provides the complete structural data for all sixteen Khalilian meters and the major Nabati meters, formatted for direct use in AI generation prompts and prosodic validation.

A.1 All Sixteen Khalilian Meters — Quick Reference

Table A.1: Complete Khalilian meter reference

Meter	Sadr Tafeelat	Main Aruz Form	Frequency
الطويل	فَعُولُنْ مَفَاعِيلُنْ فَعُولُنْ مَفَاعِيلُنْ	(مقبوضة) فَعُولُ	Very common
المديد	فَاعَلَاتُنْ فَاعِلُنْ فَاعَلَاتُنْ	فَاعَلَاتُنْ / فَاعِلُنْ	Rare
البسيط	مُسْتَفْعِلُنْ فَاعِلُنْ مُسْتَفْعِلُنْ فَاعِلُنْ	(محبونة) مُفَاعِلُنْ	Very common
الوافر	مُفَاعَلَتُنْ مُفَاعَلَتُنْ فَعُولُنْ	(مقطوف) مَفَاعِيلُنْ	Common
الكامل	مُتَفَاعِلُنْ مُتَفَاعِلُنْ مُتَفَاعِلُنْ	مُتَفَاعِلُنْ / مُتَفَاعِلُنْ	Very common
الهنجز	مَفَاعِيلُنْ مَفَاعِيلُنْ	مَفَاعِيلُنْ / مَفَاعِيلُنْ	Common
الرجز	مُسْتَفْعِلُنْ مُسْتَفْعِلُنْ مُسْتَفْعِلُنْ	Multiple	Very common
الرمل	فَاعَلَاتُنْ فَاعَلَاتُنْ فَاعَلَاتُنْ	فَاعَلَاتُنْ / فَاعَلَا (محذوف)	Common

(continued from previous page)

Meter	Sadr Tafeelat	Main Aruz Form	Frequency
السريع	مُسْتَفْعِلُنْ مَفْعُولَاتُ	مُسْتَفْعِلُنْ (موقوف) مَفْعُولَاتُ	Moderate
المنسرح	مُسْتَفْعِلُنْ مَفْعُولَاتُ مُسْتَفْعِلُنْ	مُسْتَفْعِلُنْ مُسْتَفْعِلُنْ	Rare
الخفيف	مُسْتَفْعِلُنْ مُسْتَفْعِلُنْ لَنْ	فَاعِلَاتُنْ / فَعِلَاتُنْ فَاعِلَاتُنْ مُسْتَفْعِلُنْ	Moderate
المضارع	مَفَاعِيلُنْ فَاعِلَاتُنْ	فَاعِلَاتُنْ	Very rare
المقتضب	مَفْعُولَاتُ مُسْتَفْعِلُنْ	مُسْتَفْعِلُنْ	Nearly extinct
المجثث	مُسْتَفْعِلُنْ لَنْ فَاعِلَاتُنْ	فَاعِلَاتُنْ / فَعِلَاتُنْ	Rare
المتقارب	فَعُولُنْ فَعُولُنْ فَعُولُنْ فَعُولُنْ	فَعُولُ / فَعْلُ	Common
المتدارك	فَاعِلُنْ فَاعِلُنْ فَاعِلُنْ فَاعِلُنْ	Multiple	Moderate

A.2 Zehaf Reference

Table A.2: Main zehafs and their effects

Zehaf	Arabic	Effect	Applicable Feet
Al-Khabn	الخبن	Removes 2nd element	فَعْلُنْ → فَاعِلُنْ; مُفَاعِلُنْ → مُسْتَفْعِلُنْ
Al-Tay	الطي	Removes 4th element	مُسْتَفْعِلُنْ → مُسْتَفْعِلُنْ
Al-Khabal	الخبيل	Khabn + Tay (removes 2nd + 4th)	مُتَعِلُنْ → مُفَاعِلُنْ → مُسْتَفْعِلُنْ
Al-Qabadh	القبض	Removes 5th element	مَفَاعِيلُنْ → فَعُولُنْ; فَعُولُنْ → فَعُولُنْ
Al-Kaff	الكف	Removes 7th element	فَاعِلَاتُنْ → فَاعِلَاتُنْ; مُفَاعِيلُنْ → مُفَاعِيلُنْ
Al-'Asab	العصب	Quiescs 5th element	مَفَاعِلَاتُنْ → مَفَاعِلَاتُنْ (Wafir only)
Al-Idmaar	الإضمار	Quiescs 2nd element	مُتَفَاعِلُنْ → مُتَفَاعِلُنْ
Al-Waqas	الوقص	Removes 2nd element	مُتَفَاعِلُنْ (rare)

A.3 Nabati Meters Quick Reference

Table A.3: Major Nabati meters summary

Meter	Arabic	Approximate tern	Pat-	Rhyme	Notes
Al-Mashhub	المسحوب	مستفعلن فاعلاتن	مستفعلن	Dual	Most common Nabati meter
Al-Hilali	الهلالي	مستفعلن فاعلاتن (long)	مستفعلن	Single	Oldest; ancestor of Mashhub
Al-Hijini	الهجيني	Mixed Sari' / Baseet		Single	Camel-riding, jour- ney
Al-Sakhri	الصخري	Wafir-like		Single	Narrative
Al-Hida'	الحدا'	Rajaz-like		Single	Camel-driving, mar- tial
Al-Zuhayri	الزهيري	مستفعلن فاعلن مستفعلن		Single	Dense rhyming
Bahr al-Funun	بحر الفنون	فاعلاتن فاعلاتن فاعلن		Single	Innovated by Ibn La'bun
Al-Samiri	السامري	Mashhub-derived		Dual	Nocturnal perfor- mance

Appendix B

Glossary of Arabic Poetry Terms

البحر (al-Bahr) Literally “the sea”; the term for a classical Arabic meter. Plural: بحور.

البيت (al-Bayt) A verse (literally “the house”): a complete unit of classical Arabic poetry consisting of two hemistichs (sadr + ajuz).

الشطر (al-Shatr)

A hemistich: one half of a bayt. Each bayt has two shatrs.

الصدر (al-Sadr)

The first hemistich of a bayt (literally “the chest”).

العجز (al-'Ajuz)

The second hemistich of a bayt (literally “the rear/end”).

التفعيلة (al-Tafeela)

A metrical foot in Arabic prosody. Plural: تفعيلات.

الزحاف (al-Zehaf)

A licensed deviation from the canonical foot pattern in the middle (hashw) of a hemistich. Zehafs are “permissible” — they may or may not appear and still yield a valid verse.

العلة (al-'Ella)

A mandatory modification of the aruz or dharb (the last foot of a hemistich). Unlike zehafs, ellas are *fixed* once a particular aruz/dharb is chosen — they must appear consistently.

الحشو (al-Hashw)

The middle feet of a hemistich — all feet except the last. Zehafs apply to hashw.

العروض (al-'Arud)

The last foot of the first hemistich (sadr). Its modification is an علة

عروضية.

الضرب (al-Dharb)

The last foot of the second hemistich (ajuz). Its modification is an علة ضربية.

القافية (al-Qafiya)

The rhyme system — specifically, the cluster of letters at the end of each verse defining the poem's rhyme. Not merely the last sound but a structural unit involving up to five defined letters.

الروي (al-Rawiy)

The primary rhyme consonant — the defining letter of a poem's rhyme.

الردف (al-Radf)

A long vowel (ا، و، ي) immediately preceding the rawiy.

التأسيس (al-Ta'siis)

An alif two positions before the rawiy (with a consonant between).

القصيدة (al-Qasida)

A formal Arabic ode; typically 7+ verses on a consistent meter and rhyme.

المطلع (al-Matla')

The opening verse of a qasida. In classical poetry, the matla' is مصرّع — both hemistichs rhyme with the poem's rawiy.

المصراع (al-Misra')

An individual hemistich.

التصريع (al-Tasri')

The classical convention where the first bayt has both hemistichs rhyming with the rawiy.

الغرض (al-Gharad)

The purpose or thematic genre of a poem (madih, hija', ghazal, etc.). Plural: أغراض.

النسيب (al-Nasib)

The amatory prelude of a classical qasida; often a lament at a deserted campsite (الوقوف على الأطلال).

التخلص (al-Takhallus)

The transitional section of a qasida, moving from the opening to the

main purpose.

المدح (al-Madih)

Panegyric; praise poetry.

الهجاء (al-Hija')

Satire; invective poetry.

الغزل (al-Ghazal)

Love poetry. Two sub-types: عذري (Platonic) and حسي (sensual).

الرثاء (al-Ritha')

Elegy; mourning poetry.

الفخر (al-Fakhr)

Boasting poetry; self-glorification.

الحكمة (al-Hikma)

Wisdom poetry; philosophical aphorisms.

الزهد (al-Zuhd)

Ascetic poetry; renunciation of worldly pleasures.

الخمريات (al-Khamriyyat)

Wine poetry.

الحماسة (al-Hamasa)

Martial/heroic poetry.

المعارضة (al-Mu'arada)

A response poem using the same meter and rhyme as an existing poem.

المساجلة (al-Musajala)

Poetic competition between two poets exchanging verses on the same meter and rhyme.

التضمن (al-Tadmin)

Incorporating another poet's verse into one's own poem.

التشطير (al-Tashtir)

Inserting a new hemistich before each hemistich of an existing poem.

التخميس (al-Takhmiis)

Adding three new hemistichs to each verse of an existing poem.

المحاوراة (al-Muhawara)

Improvised real-time poetic dueling (Hijazi term).

القلطة (al-Qalta)

Same as Muhawara (Najdi/Gulf term).

الطريق (al-Tariq)

The melody-meter path used in Muhawara/Qalta. Plural: طرق.

العرضة (al-'Ardah)

A tribal martial performance with poetry, song, and choreography.

السامري (al-Samri)

A Najdi nocturnal performance tradition using Nabati poetry.

الزجل (al-Zajal)

Levantine/Egyptian colloquial strophic poetry tradition.

المسحوب (al-Mashhub)

The dominant Nabati meter; characterised by a dual-rhyme system.

الهلالي (al-Hilali)

The oldest Nabati meter; named for Banu Hilal tribe.

القافية المزدوجة (al-Qafiya al-Muzdawaja)

The dual-rhyme system: distinct rhymes for *sadr* and *ajuz* hemistichs in Nabati poetry.

شعر التفعيلة (Shi'r al-Tafila)

Metrical free verse: retains classical foot patterns but uses variable line lengths; no fixed hemistich structure.

قصيدة النثر (Qasidat al-Nathr)

Prose poem: abandons both meter and rhyme; evaluated on imagery density and internal rhythm.

التشكيل / التشكيل (al-Tashkeel)

Full diacritics (*harakaat*) on Arabic text, required for prosodic scanning.

الدائرة العروضية (al-Da'ira al-'Arudiyya)

One of al-Khalil's five abstract prosodic circles organising related meters.